The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties

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The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties

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Given separately.

Declaration

I hereby declare that the Individual Research Paper titled "The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties", submitted for the DSCSC 2026 Course, is my original work. This work has not formed the basis for the award of any degree, associateship, fellowship or any other similar title.

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This is to certify that the research entitled "The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties" is the original research work carried out by Maj Sabrin Tabassum, Engineers, Course Participant of the DSCSC 2026 Course, under my direct supervision. I, therefore, recommend it to the Academic Wing for further necessary action.

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Abstract

Bangladesh Army has seven mandated roles under the Constitution, of which three are to assist the civil administration as internal deployment. Officers of the Army have therefore exercised the powers of civil administrators and police in various national emergencies. Yet no written, curricular or institutional training or test of the civil administration knowledge these duties demand has existed. This study assessed whether officers' knowledge is adequate for these duties and how any shortfall affects their performance. It followed a mixed-method design. First, the researcher identified the standard in six knowledge domains through a study of the Constitution and governing laws. A survey of 360 officers, eight interviews with senior commanders and civil officials, and two focus group discussions then re-evaluated that standard through different tiers of officers. The primary data were analysed through frequencies, mean scores, group comparisons and thematic analysis. By evaluating their own performance, officers stated what they need to know and how much they know, based on the ground realities of the prolonged and challenging deployment of 2024.

Through the performance indicators and assessments, officers were found to fall short of the functional knowledge these duties require, particularly in human rights compliance, magistracy procedure and legal procedures. Knowledge did not improve with rank, service or deployments. Officers with limited knowledge met hesitation, documentation errors, over-reliance on magistrates and friction with civil officials 32 to 36 percentage points more often than better-informed officers. Further analysis pointed to six institutional factors that sustain the gap in a cycle, which shows that the gap is institutional rather than individual. The study therefore recommends a career-long knowledge pathway, an examined module, revised doctrine, field legal support, joint training with civil agencies and a field exercise before such duties are performed.

Keywords: aid to civil administration, civil administration knowledge, knowledge gap, magistracy powers, military training, Bangladesh Army

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List of Abbreviations

AHQ	Army Headquarters
ARTDOC	Army Training and Doctrine Command
BMA	Bangladesh Military Academy
BPATC	Bangladesh Public Administration Training Centre
CrPC	Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898
DC	Deputy Commissioner and District Magistrate
DSCSC	Defence Services Command and Staff College
FGD	Focus group discussion
H0	Null hypothesis
H1	Alternative hypothesis
JAG	Judge Advocate General's department
M	Mean
MOOTW	Military operations other than war
n, *N*	Number of respondents in a group, in the whole sample
NCO	Non-commissioned officer
NDC	National Defence College
SEM	Special Executive Magistrate; Special Executive Magistracy
SI&T	School of Infantry and Tactics
SOP	Standing operating procedure
SP	Superintendent of Police
UNO	Upazila Nirbahi Officer

The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties

Chapter I
Introduction

Background

Bangladesh Army has been employed in aid to civil power since independence: after the cyclone of 1991 (Smith, 1995) and Cyclone Sidr in 2007 (United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, 2007), during the Rohingya influx of 2017 (VOA News, 2017) and the COVID-19 pandemic (Armed Forces Division, n.d.; Press Trust of India, 2020), and in restoring law and order (Bangladesh Army, n.d.-b). Employment has not always been free of controversy: Operation Clean Heart in 2002 led to deaths in detention (World Organisation Against Torture, 2002), and the High Court later declared its indemnity law illegal (BBC News Bangla, 2015). The Army always works under the civil administration, so its officers must understand how that administration functions.

The duties changed sharply in 2024. After the July uprising a curfew was imposed and the Army deployed (Al Jazeera, 2024), and routine policing collapsed. On 17 September 2024 the Ministry of Public Administration gave commissioned Army officers the powers of an Executive Magistrate under Sections 12(1) and 17 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC), 1898 (The Business Standard, 2024a; The Daily Star, 2024a), covering arrest, warrants, search, security proceedings and the dispersal of unlawful assemblies (The Daily Star, 2024c). The powers were extended to the Navy and Air Force (bdnews24.com, 2024).

They were renewed from November 2024 through 2025, the last nationwide renewal running until 28 February 2026 (The Daily Star, 2025). Troops recovered looted weapons (Sarkar, 2024; United News of Bangladesh, 2026a), joined raids (The Business Standard, 2024c) and deployed about 100,000 troops to 544 camps for the election of 12 February 2026 (The Business Standard, 2026). Although the Army was to return to barracks once the new government took oath (United News of Bangladesh,

2026b), the powers were restored from 22 to 30 June 2026 in three metropolitan areas and three districts (Biswas, 2026; The Financial Express, 2026).

Police and civil officers are formally trained before they use such powers; Army officers used the same powers without institutional training, a written standard or a test. This gap between authority and knowledge is the background of the study. The Army calls these duties aid to civil power, but the 2024 order deployed troops in aid to civil administration, the term used in this paper.

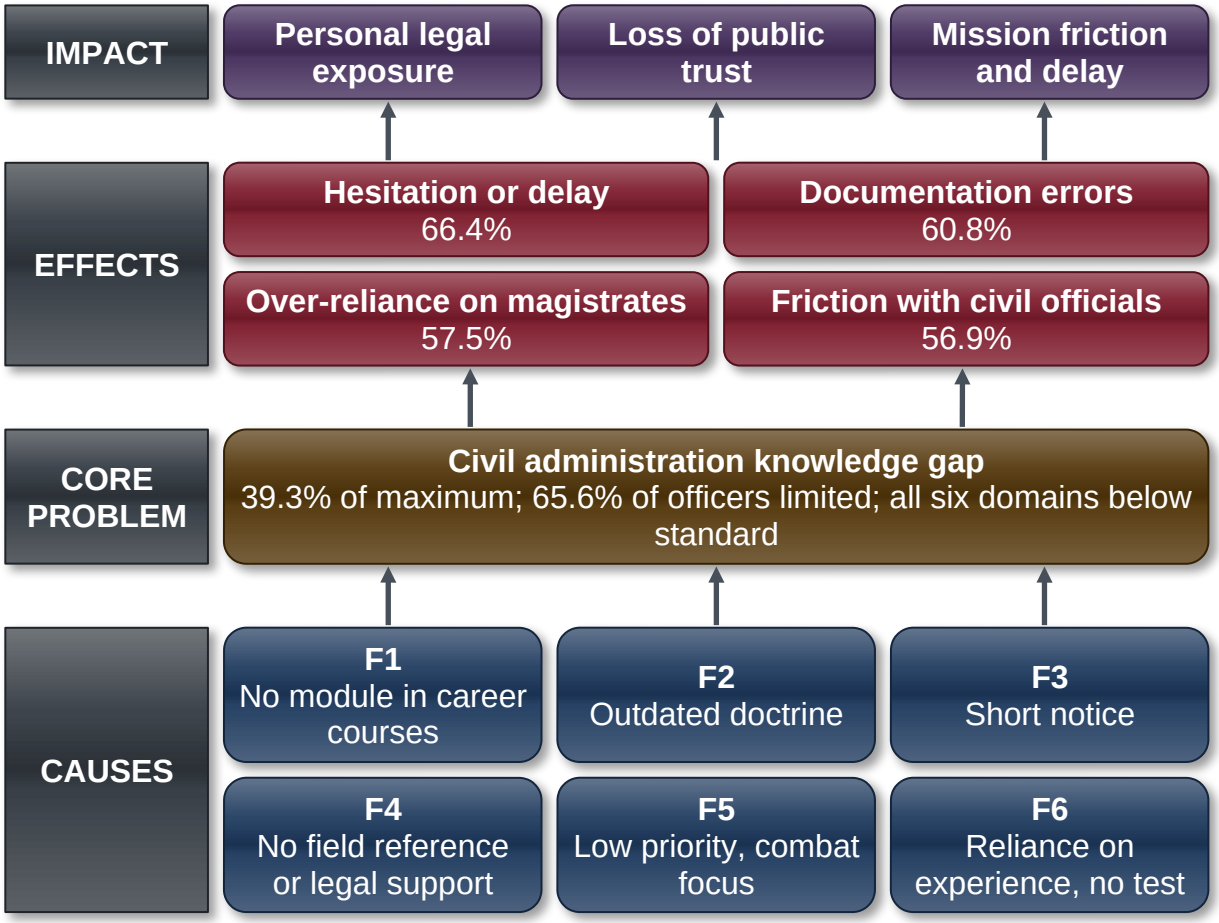
Statement of the Problem

Aid to civil administration is a specified role of Bangladesh Army (Bangladesh Army, n.d.-a). It demands knowledge of civil law, magistracy procedure, inter-agency coordination, human rights, crowd management and communication with civil authorities. When the powers were given, the press warned against misuse (The Daily Star, 2024b), political leaders asked that they be used only where necessary (The Business Standard, 2024b), and international studies show that military curricula give civil tasks limited weight (Reed et al., 2020).

Officers thus exercised magisterial and law-enforcement powers without a defined standard of knowledge, structured training or assessment. Neither the size of the resulting gap nor its effect on performance has been measured. This study measures the gap, explains why it exists and suggests how to reduce it. Figure 1.1 shows the problem as a chain from causes to impact.

Figure 1.1

Problem Tree of the Civil Administration Knowledge Gap



Note. Researcher's own construct. Percentages are officers meeting each problem often or always.

Review of Literature

The review covered books, articles, doctrine, statutes, notifications and press reports, and asked four questions: the limits of military involvement in civil functions, the knowledge such work needs, the practice of comparable forces, and the Bangladesh context (Table 1.1).

Huntington (1957) held that the military is most effective when it specialises in violence and civilians keep administration; Janowitz (1960) accepted a wider constabulary role in which forces build social and administrative competence. They differ on the role but agree that officers must hold the relevant knowledge first. Becker (1964) treats training as an investment with measurable returns. Spencer and Spencer (1993) separate visible competence, namely knowledge and skill, which can be

defined, trained and tested, from deeper traits. In Bangladesh, Hassan et al. (2026) found that the civil service already teaches and checks legal knowledge.

Croissant et al. (2013) treated internal security as a test of civilian control in new Asian democracies, including Bangladesh. Reed et al. (2020) found that United States doctrine gives limited attention to the competencies needed for humanitarian and disaster relief tasks, and Ries (2022), reviewing 45 publications from 22 countries, found clear frameworks and joint civil-military exercises common to effective coordination. Ahamed (1988) traces the Army's custodian-of-order outlook to its British Indian and Pakistani predecessors, and Sahoo and Vishwanathan (2023) trace the move from military dominance towards civilian control. None measures the knowledge of the officers who exercise civil authority. The Constitution, the CrPC and the Penal Code state what an officer must know (Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898; Constitution of the People's Republic of Bangladesh, 1972; Penal Code, 1860), but the two volumes of Army doctrine on military operations other than war (MOOTW) do not cover the legal, magisterial or coordination domains (Army Training and Doctrine Command [ARTDOC], 2016a, 2016b).

Table 1.1

Literature Concept Matrix

Source	Civil-military boundary	Knowledge and competence	Training and doctrine	Joint coordination	Bangladesh context	Measures officers' knowledge
Huntington (1957)	●	○				
Janowitz (1960)	●	●	○	○		
Becker (1964)		●	●			
Spencer and Spencer (1993)		●	○			
Ahamed (1988)	●				●	
Croissant et al. (2013)	●			○	○	
Reed et al. (2020)		●	●			
Ries (2022)			○	●		
Sahoo and Vishwanathan (2023)	●				●	
Hassan et al. (2026)		●	●		●	
ARTDOC (2016a, 2016b)			●	○	●	
CrPC, Constitution, Penal Code		●			●	
This study (2026)	●	●	●	●	●	●

Note. Researcher's coding. ● = main theme; ○ = treated in part.

The literature points one way from four angles: theory warns that a civil role without civil knowledge carries risk; the law defines the knowledge, which doctrine omits; and studies of other forces trace the deficit to training and doctrine, not to individuals. Any gap is therefore likely to be organisational, and the required knowledge can be set from law and practice and then measured.

Research Gap

No study has defined the civil administration knowledge an Army officer needs, measured what officers hold, or linked the shortfall to performance. The empty last column of Table 1.1 shows this gap.

Theoretical Framework

A theoretical framework supplies the lens through which an issue is examined. Here it explains why a gap may exist, how it can be measured and what could close it. Four theories are used; Figure 1.2 shows how they connect and where each is used, and Table 1.2 traces each from concept to indicator.

Theories of the Military Role

Huntington's (1957) objective civilian control rests on professional specialisation and a clear boundary between military and civil functions; the military crosses that boundary if it works in a field in which it is untrained, so a civil role without civil knowledge risks the task and the institution. Janowitz's (1960) constabulary concept accepts that modern forces will perform internal security tasks but holds that they must be trained for them. The theories differ on whether the military should take the role, yet agree that knowledge must precede performance. This is the first proposition: knowledge must come before authority (P1).

Theories of Knowledge

Becker's (1964) human capital theory treats knowledge as the product of deliberate investment in training; where a task is assigned without it, knowledge stays low and output falls. This gives the second proposition: without institutional training a gap persists regardless of rank or experience (P2). Spencer and Spencer's (1993) competency model separates visible layers, knowledge and skill, from hidden ones such as motive and trait; the visible layers can be compared with a standard, taught and tested. This gives the third proposition: the gap can be defined, measured and reduced (P3).

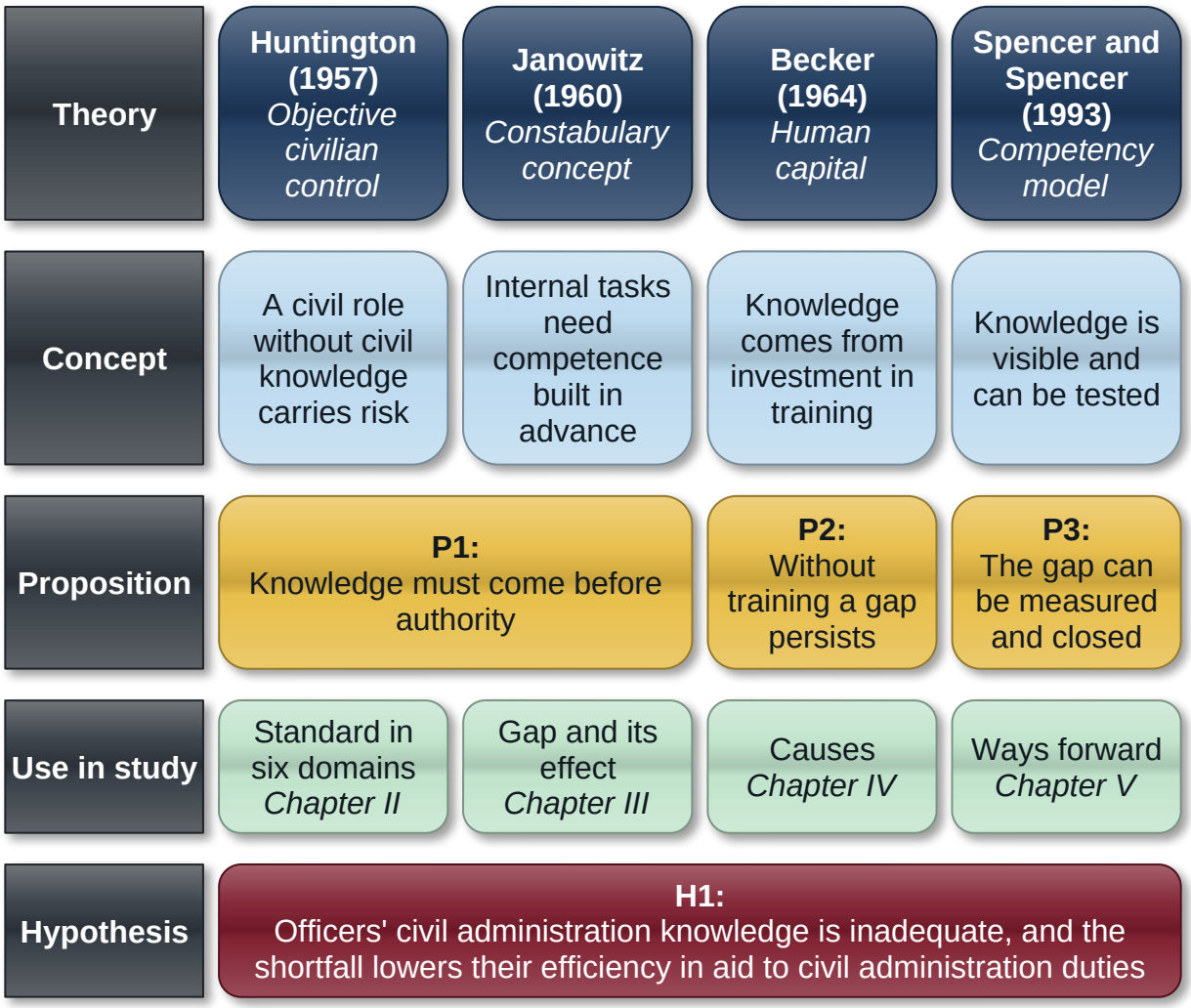
Correlation Among the Theories

The theories form one chain: knowledge must precede authority; human capital theory explains why it may not, namely absent investment; and the competency model makes it measurable through a written standard and a test. Together they predict that

officers given civil powers without training will show a measurable gap that lowers performance. This prediction is the hypothesis.

Figure 1.2

Theoretical Framework of the Study



Note. Researcher's own construct. P = proposition; H1 = alternative hypothesis.

How the Framework Guides the Analysis

The framework guides each stage. P1 and the competency model justify a written standard in six domains (Chapter II); P3 allows the gap to be measured and its effect read through four problems on the ground (Chapter III); P2 directs the search for causes to training, doctrine and assessment rather than individual failings (Chapter IV) and shapes the ways forward (Chapter V). If the theory holds, experience alone will not close the gap, which Chapter III tests.

Table 1.2

Operationalisation Matrix: From Theory to Indicator

Theory	Key concept	Proposition	Variable	Indicator used	Tested in
Huntington (1957)	Specialisation and boundary	P1: knowledge before authority	Independent: knowledge in six domains	Nine knowledge items, six-point scale	Ch II, III
Janowitz (1960)	Competence built in advance	P1: knowledge before authority	Independent: knowledge in six domains	Domain importance; expert views	Ch II
Becker (1964)	Investment in training	P2: without training a gap persists	Factors F1 to F6; training, rank, service	Course coverage; factor agreement	Ch III, IV
Spencer and Spencer (1993)	Visible, testable competence	P3: gap can be measured and closed	Gap; dependent: four problems	Gap in points; frequency of problems	Ch III, V

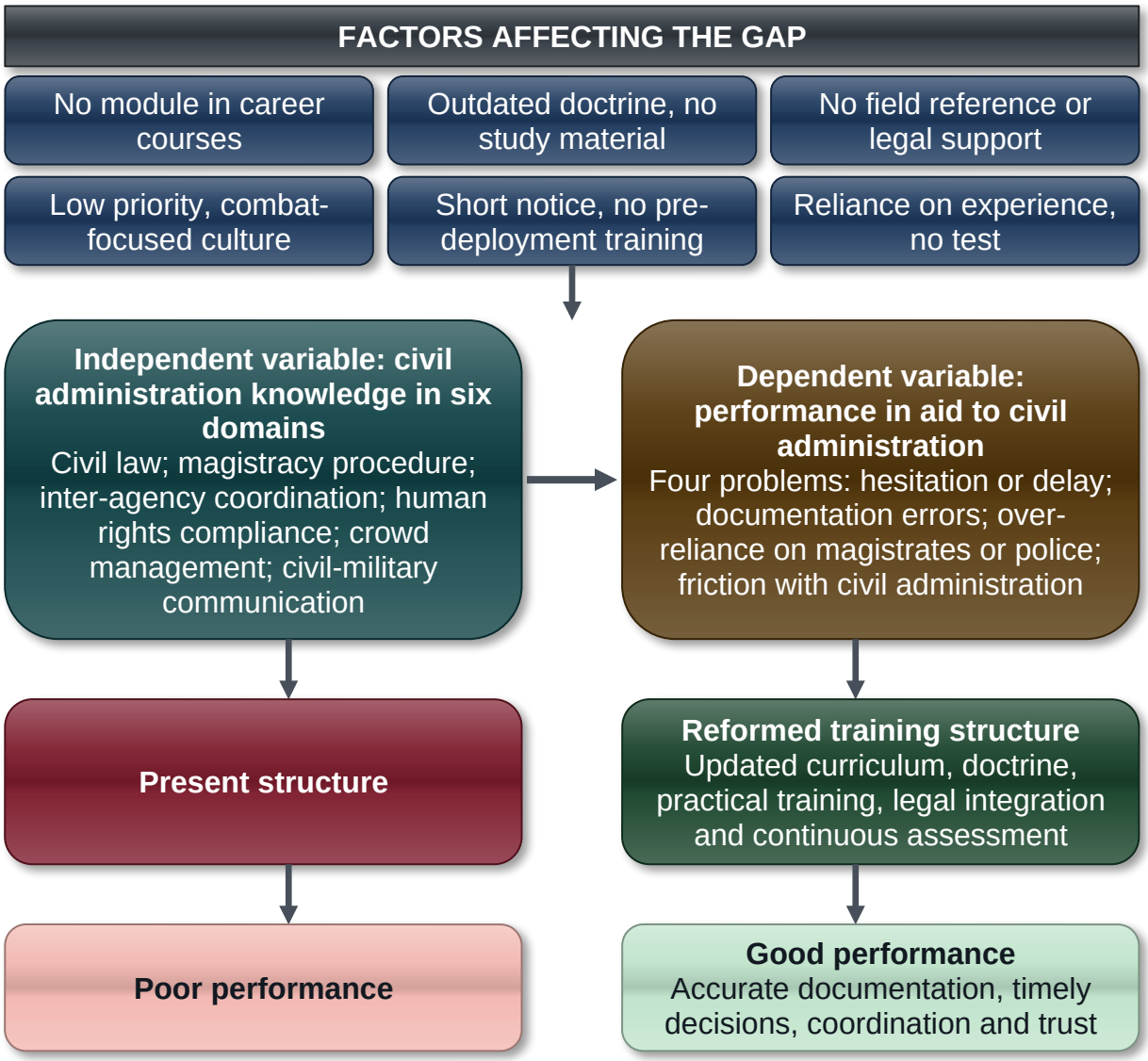
Note. Researcher's own construct. P = proposition.

Conceptual Framework

The conceptual framework turns the theory into observable variables (Figure 1.3). The independent variable is officers' civil administration knowledge in six domains: civil law, magistracy procedure, inter-agency coordination, human rights compliance, crowd management and civil-military communication. The dependent variable is performance in aid to civil administration, read through four problems met on the ground: hesitation or delay, documentation errors, over-reliance on magistrates or police, and friction with the civil administration. Fewer problems mean better performance.

Figure 1.3

Conceptual Framework: Factors, Knowledge Domains and Performance



Note. Researcher's own construct from Figure 1.2.

Aim of the Research

The aim is to assess the civil administration knowledge gap among Bangladesh Army officers and its effect on performance in aid to civil administration duties, and to recommend measures to reduce it.

Research Objectives

Broad Objective

To assess the nature and extent of the knowledge gap among Bangladesh Army officers on the functional understanding of civil administration, in order to perform aid to civil administration duties efficiently.

Specific Objectives

1. To determine the knowledge an officer requires to perform aid to civil administration duties, and how it affects performance during deployment.
2. To measure the present state of civil administration knowledge among officers from lieutenant to lieutenant colonel with experience of these duties.
3. To determine the gap between existing and required knowledge.
4. To identify the factors that contribute to the gap.
5. To recommend measures to enhance officers' knowledge for aid to civil administration duties.

Research Questions

The study asks one primary and four secondary questions. Table 1.3 links each to its objective, method and chapter.

Table 1.3

Research Questions, Objectives, Methods and Chapters

Research question	Objective	Method	Chapter
Primary: Is present knowledge adequate to perform aid to civil administration duties effectively?	Broad	Mixed methods (quantitative and qualitative)	III and V
1. What knowledge is required, and how does it affect performance while deployed?	1	Document study; interviews	II
2. What is the existing state of knowledge, and what is the gap with the required knowledge?	2 and 3	Survey; interviews; FGDs	III
3. What factors affect the knowledge gap?	4	Survey; interviews; FGDs; comparison with other institutions	IV
4. What measures are recommended to enhance knowledge and reduce the gap?	5	All sources; comparison with other institutions	V

Note. Researcher's own construct. FGD = focus group discussion.

Hypothesis

Alternative Hypothesis (H1)

The civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers is inadequate, and this inadequacy lowers their efficiency in aid to civil administration duties.

Null Hypothesis (H0)

The civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers is adequate, or any shortfall has no significant effect on their efficiency in aid to civil administration duties.

Research Variables

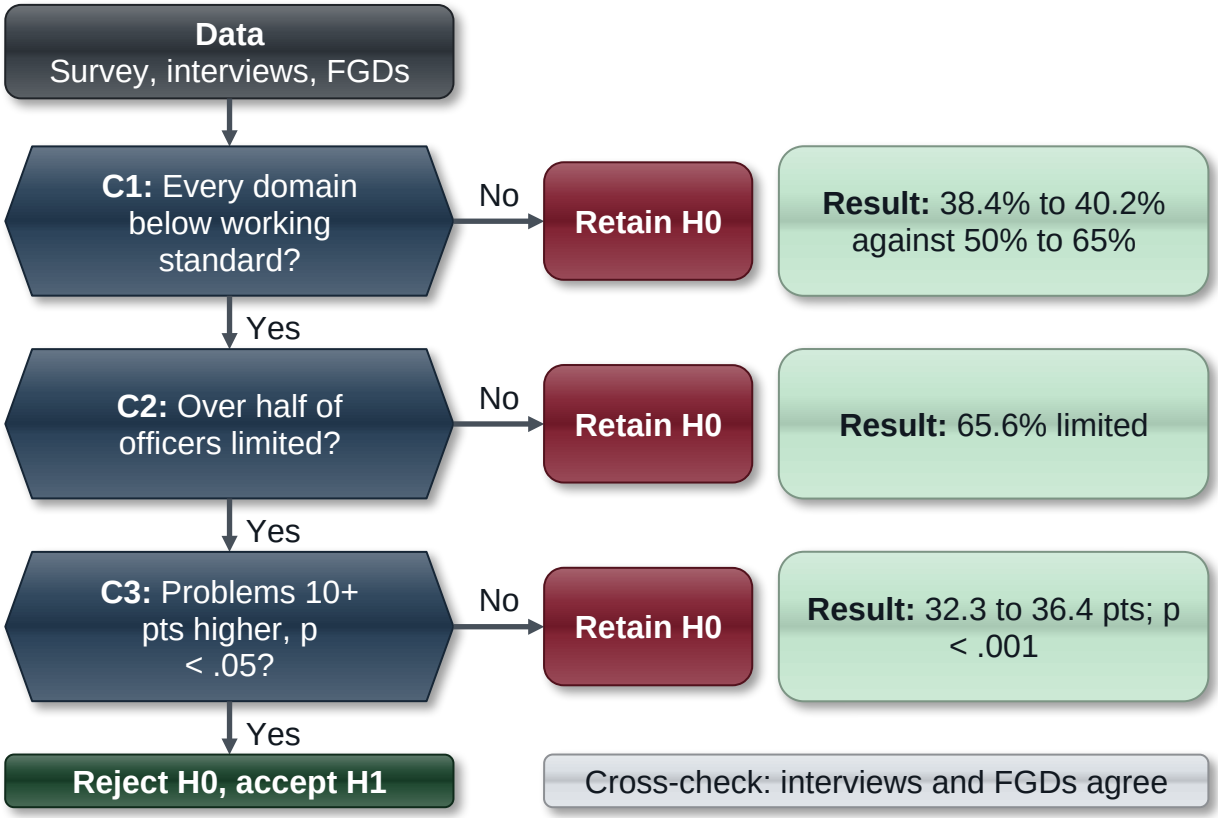
The independent variable is officers' knowledge in the six domains; the dependent variable is their efficiency, measured by how often they meet the four problems of Figure 1.3.

How and Where the Hypothesis Is Tested

The hypothesis is tested in Chapter III against a decision rule fixed in advance (Figure 1.4). H0 is rejected only if three conditions are met: mean knowledge is below the working standard of Chapter II in every domain; more than half of the officers have limited knowledge; and officers with limited knowledge meet each of the four problems at least 10 percentage points more often than others, each difference being significant in a two-proportion z-test ($p < .05$). The first two conditions test inadequacy and the third the effect on efficiency. The result is cross-checked against the interviews and FGDs.

Figure 1.4

Hypothesis Decision Tree



Note. Researcher's own construct; results from Chapter III.

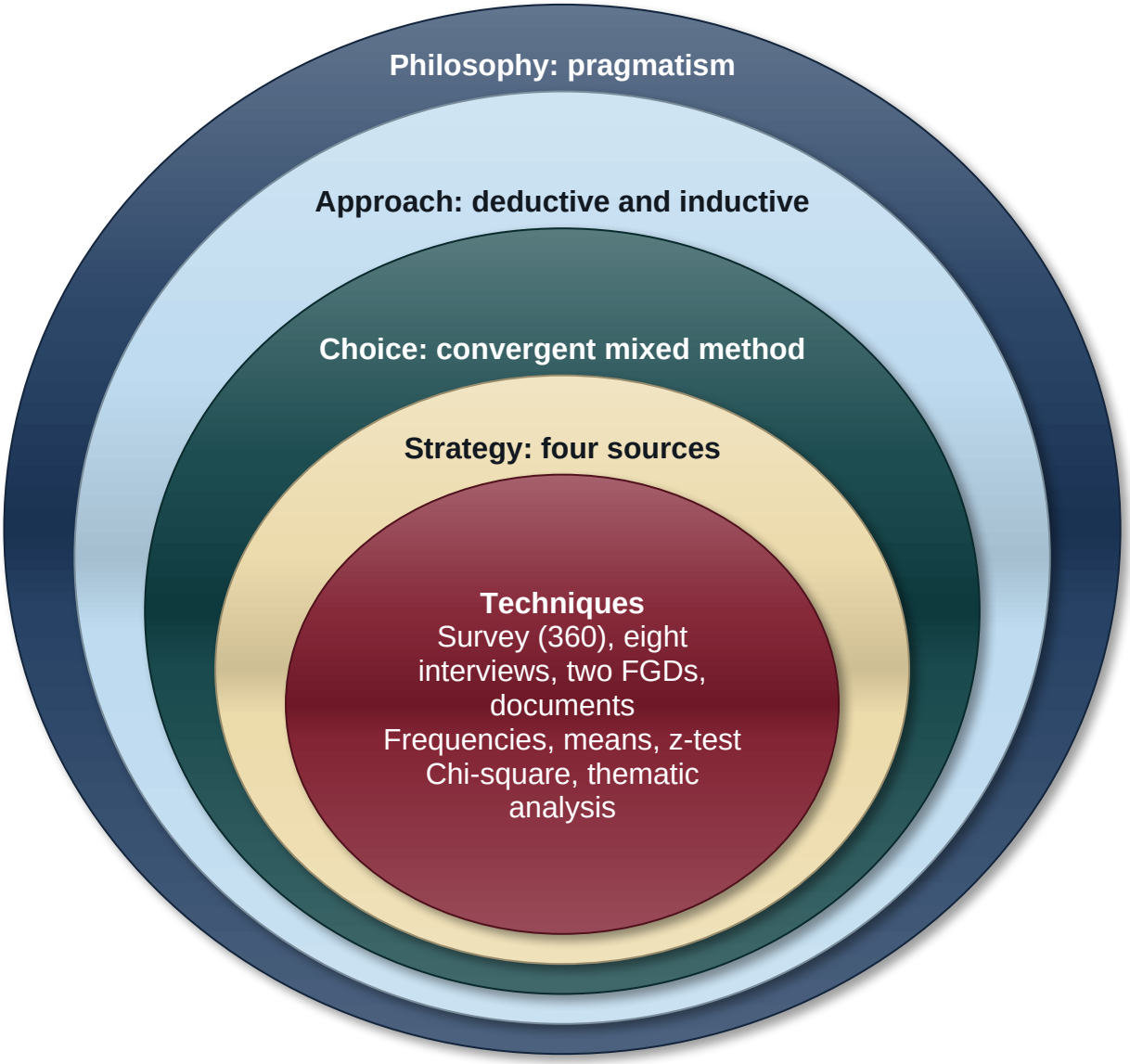
Research Methodology

Research Design

The study used a mixed-method design (Creswell & Creswell, 2018) (Figure 1.5). Document study set the standard of knowledge, a survey measured the gap and its effect, and interviews and focus group discussions (FGDs) explained the causes and tested whether the survey results held.

Figure 1.5

Research Design Layers



Note. Adapted from the layered research design model.

Population and Sample

The population was about 1,000 officers up to lieutenant colonel with experience in aid to civil administration. Cochran's (1977) formula, corrected for this population, required 278 responses for a 5% margin of error at 95% confidence (Annexure B); 360 valid responses gave a margin of error of 4.1%. Participation was voluntary, so the sample is not strictly random.

Data Collection

The survey ran on Google Forms from 17 to 31 July 2026 (Annexure A). Eight interviews were held in July 2026: six with senior commanders and directors, and two with the Deputy Commissioner and District Magistrate (DC) and the Superintendent of Police (SP) of Sylhet (Annexure D). Two FGDs were held, at the Defence Services Command and Staff College (DSCSC) with four junior officers and with the command group of an infantry battalion (Annexure E). Laws, notifications, doctrine and press reports formed the documentary data (Table 1.4).

Table 1.4

Sources of Data

Source	Respondents or material	Used for
Document study	Laws, notifications, doctrine, press reports and training records	Standard and comparisons (Chapter II)
Survey	*N* = 360 officers, lieutenant to lieutenant colonel, with experience in aid to civil administration	Knowledge, gap and effect (Chapter III); causes and measures (Chapters IV and V)
Interviews	Six senior commanders and directors; the DC and SP of Sylhet	Standard, effects, causes and measures
Focus group discussions	Four junior officers; the command group of an infantry battalion	Effects and causes

Note. Instruments and summaries are at Annexures A, D and E.

Data Analysis

Survey answers were analysed with frequencies, percentages and mean scores read against Table 1.5 (Annexure B), and the main group differences with a two-proportion z-test. Interview and FGD records were analysed by theme (Braun & Clarke, 2006). Findings from each source were compared so that no argument rests on the survey alone (Figure 1.6); Figure 1.7 shows the flow of the research.

Figure 1.6

Triangulation of the Sources

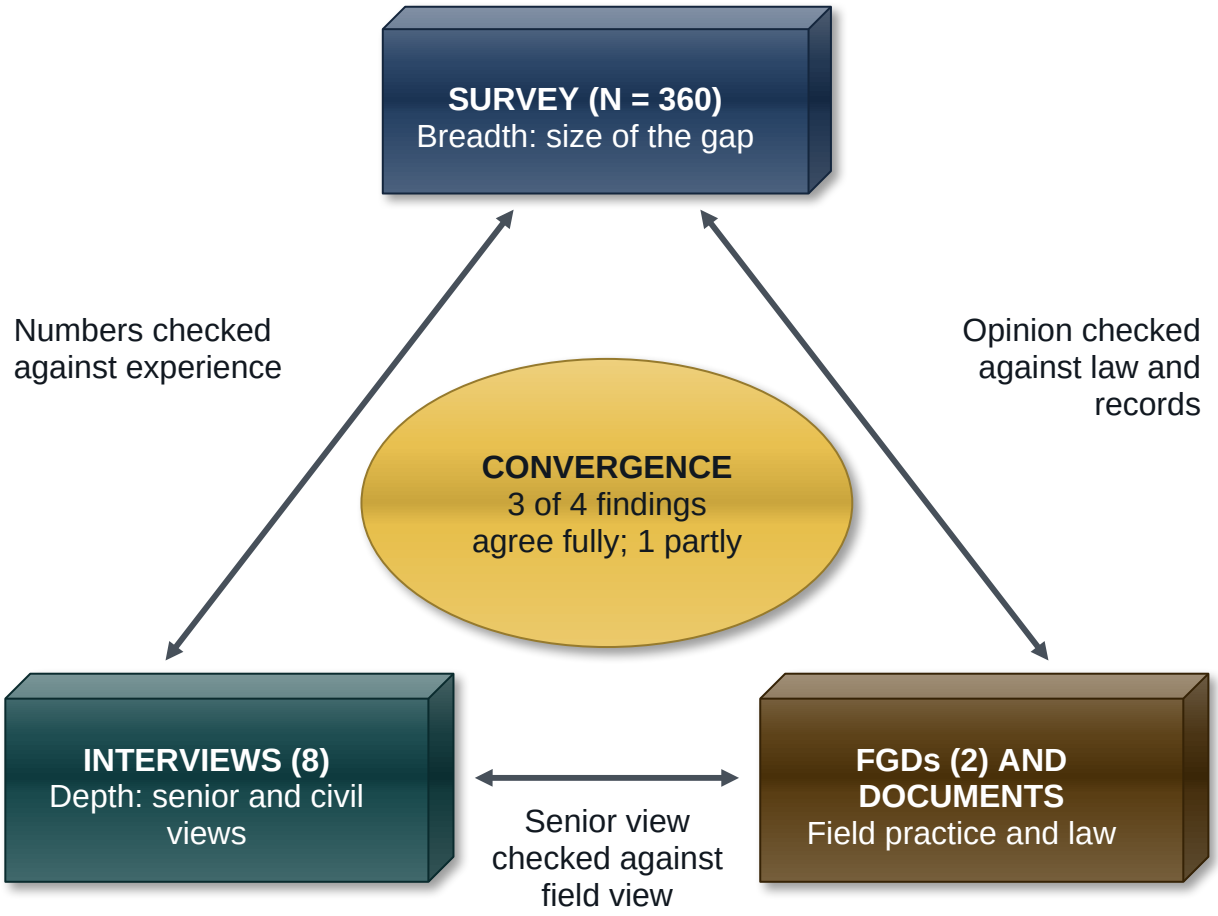


Figure 1.7

Research Flow from Problem to Test of the Hypothesis

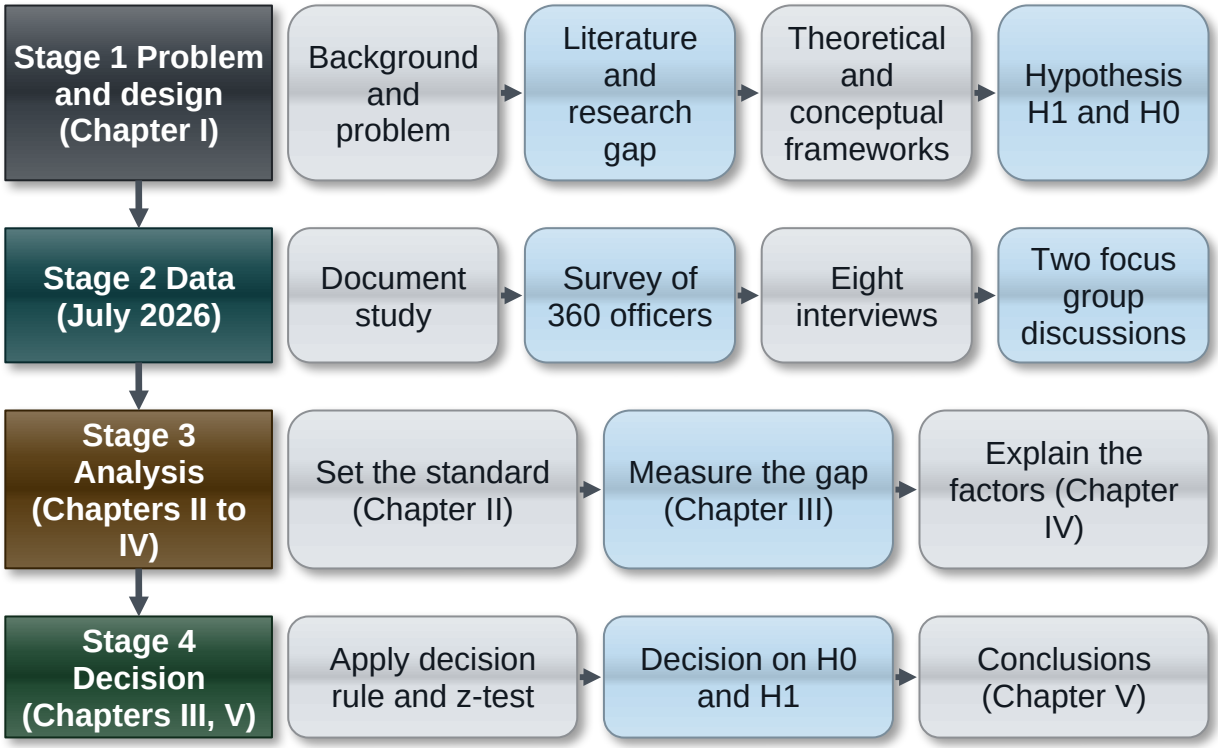


Table 1.5

Bands Used to Interpret Mean Scores

Six-point mean	Knowledge level	Five-point mean	Frequency or agreement
1.00 to 1.82	Very limited	1.00 to 1.79	Never; strongly disagree
1.83 to 2.66	Limited	1.80 to 2.59	Rarely; disagree
2.67 to 3.49	Moderate	2.60 to 3.39	Sometimes; neutral
3.50 to 4.32	Adequate	3.40 to 4.19	Often; agree
4.33 to 5.16	High	4.20 to 5.00	Always; strongly agree
5.17 to 6.00	Very high	Not applicable	Not applicable

Note. Researcher's own construct; bands are of equal width.

Scope and Limitations

Scope

The study covers Bangladesh Army officers up to lieutenant colonel with experience in aid to civil administration; it excludes junior commissioned officers, other ranks, the Navy and the Air Force.

Limitations

a. Knowledge was self-assessed rather than tested. Professionals tend to rate themselves generously, so the true gap may be larger.
b. Serving officers may have softened criticism of their institution, although answers were analysed only in aggregate.
c. Some opinion items drew agreement of 85% or more and may be truisms; they are used only as supporting evidence, and the main tests rest on knowledge ratings and the frequency of problems.
d. The magistracy arrangement changed several times, so the findings need periodic review.

Chapterisation

The paper has five chapters: Chapter I states the problem, theory and design; Chapter II sets the standard of knowledge; Chapter III measures knowledge and tests the hypothesis; Chapter IV analyses the factors behind the gap; and Chapter V gives the conclusions and recommendations.

Chapter II
Expected Level of Knowledge Needed from Officers

General

No written standard of civil administration knowledge exists for Army officers, even after the powers of 2024, and a gap can only be measured against a known requirement. This chapter builds one from theory, the law, deployment practice, the views of officers and experts, doctrine and comparable institutions.

Requirement of the Theories

The theories of Chapter I lead to one requirement: a civil role carries risk without civil knowledge (Huntington, 1957; Janowitz, 1960), knowledge follows investment in training (Becker, 1964), and knowledge can be written down and tested (Spencer & Spencer, 1993). The Army therefore needs a written standard, taught and assessed before officers exercise civil powers.

What the Law Requires

The law is the most precise source. Sections 12(1) and 17 of the CrPC allow the government to confer magistracy powers under the District Magistrate, and Sections 127 to 132 govern the dispersal of unlawful assemblies, requiring as little force as possible. The Constitution, the recently inserted CrPC arrest safeguards and Appellate Division guidelines protect every arrested person (Bangladesh v. Bangladesh Legal Aid and Services Trust, 2016; Code of Criminal Procedure (Amendment) Act, 2026), while the Penal Code and the Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act make an officer personally liable for wrongful confinement and ill-treatment (Penal Code, 1860; Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013).

Two limits matter. Sections 129 and 131, on military force, were not delegated, so that decision stays with the senior civil magistrate, and Section 132 protects only acts done lawfully and in good faith. An officer unaware of these limits may exceed the authority given and lose the law's protection.

What the Deployments Demanded

In 2024 to 2026 officers arrested suspects, executed warrants, searched premises, recovered looted weapons, dispersed crowds and secured polling centres (Sarkar, 2024; The Business Standard, 2024c, 2026). Table 2.1 links these tasks to the provisions and knowledge involved: every task drew on at least two domains, and

most touched the two where error is costliest, magistracy procedure and human rights compliance.

Table 2.1

Tasks of the 2024 to 2026 Deployments and the Knowledge They Demanded

Task	Main provisions	Knowledge domains demanded
Arrest of offenders and execution of warrants	CrPC ss. 64, 65, 83 to 86; Constitution Art. 33	Civil law; magistracy procedure; human rights compliance
Search and seizure; recovery of looted weapons	CrPC ss. 100, 103, 105	Civil law; magistracy procedure; inter-agency coordination
Security proceedings for keeping the peace	CrPC ss. 107 to 110, 126	Magistracy procedure; civil law
Dispersal of unlawful assemblies	Penal Code s. 141; CrPC ss. 127, 128, 130	Crowd management; human rights compliance; civil-military communication
Removal of public nuisance	CrPC ss. 133, 142	Magistracy procedure; inter-agency coordination
Custody and handover of arrested persons	CrPC ss. 46A, 61, 167; Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013	Human rights compliance; civil law
Election security; joint operations with police	CrPC s. 17(1); deployment circulars	Inter-agency coordination; civil-military communication

Note. Based on the sources cited above and Annexure C.

Knowledge Domains and the Required Standard

Table 2.3 groups the provisions into six domains and grades each by the cost of an error, scored in Table 2.2 against five consequences. Magistracy procedure and human rights compliance are critical, because an error can void an order, harm a

citizen and expose the officer to prosecution. Civil law, crowd management and civil-military communication are severe, because errors can lose a case or lead to unlawful force; inter-agency coordination is moderate, since errors mainly cause delay and friction. Annexure C gives the provisions in full.

Table 2.2

Domain Consequence Heat Matrix

Domain	Order void or case lost	Harm to a citizen	Personal liability	Mission delay	Reputation	Score	Grade
Magistracy procedure	High	Medium	High	Medium	High	**13**	**Critical**
Human rights compliance	Medium	High	High	Low	High	**12**	**Critical**
Civil law	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	**11**	**Severe**
Crowd management	Low	High	Medium	Medium	High	**11**	**Severe**
Civil-military comm.	Low	Medium	Medium	High	Medium	**10**	**Severe**
Inter-agency coordination	Low	Low	Low	High	Medium	**8**	**Moderate**

Note. Researcher's assessment. High = 3, Medium = 2, Low = 1; score 12 or more = critical, 10 to 11 = severe, 9 or less = moderate.

Table 2.3

Knowledge Domains, Legal Basis, Grade and Required Standard

Domain	Main legal basis	Grade	Basic (%)	Working (%)	Advanced (%)
Civil law	CrPC ss. 46 to 46E, 54A, 61, 100, 103, 105, 167; Evidence Act ss. 24 to 26	Severe	40-50	55-65	70-80
Magistracy procedure	CrPC ss. 12(1), 64, 65, 83 to 86, 107 to 110, 126, 133, 142	Critical	35-45	50-60	65-75
Inter-agency coordination	CrPC s. 17(1); Police Act ss. 23, 30, 30A, 31; deployment circulars	Moderate	40-50	55-65	70-80
Human rights compliance	Constitution Arts. 27, 31 to 33, 35(5); Penal Code ss. 220, 330, 342; Torture Act; Children Act ss. 44, 45	Critical	50-60	65-75	80-90
Crowd management	Constitution Art. 37; Penal Code ss. 96 to 106, 141; CrPC ss. 127, 128	Severe	45-55	60-70	75-85
Civil-military communication	CrPC ss. 129 to 132	Severe	45-55	60-70	70-80

Note. Based on the CrPC, 1898; the Constitution (1972); the Penal Code, 1860; the Evidence Act, 1872; the Police Act, 1861; the Children Act, 2013; and the Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013. Values are percentages of the scale maximum; 50% equals a mean of 3.0 and 65% a mean of 3.9.

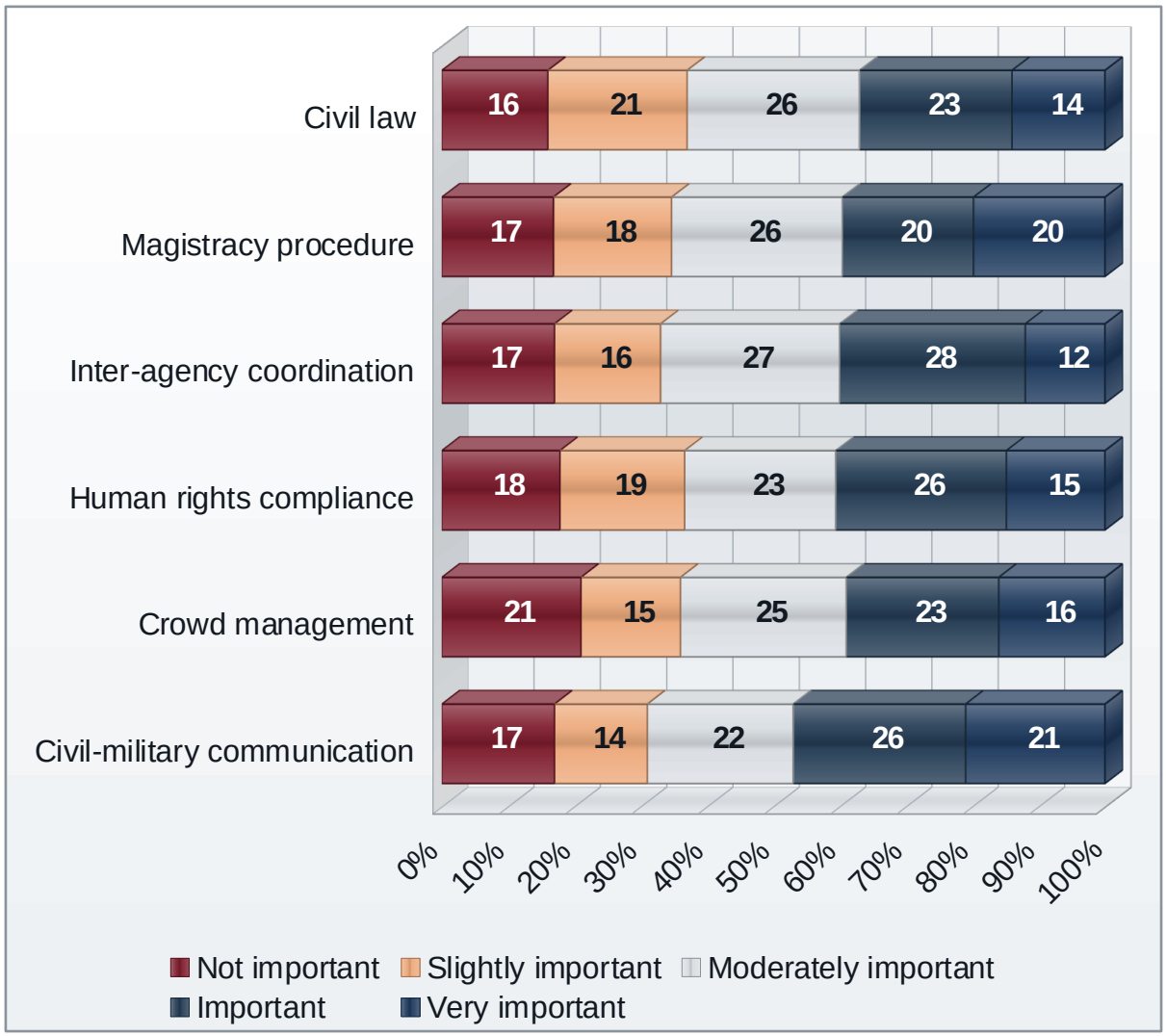
The working level is the minimum for any deployed officer: 55% where an error mainly causes delay or a weak case, 60% where it can lead to unlawful force and 65% where it can breach constitutional rights. Magistracy procedure is 50% for all officers, because not every officer holds magistracy powers, but 65% for those who do.

Officers' View of the Required Knowledge

Between 63.2% and 68.6% of officers rated each domain at least moderately important (Figure 2.1): highest for civil-military communication (68.6%) and inter-agency coordination (67.2%), lowest for civil law (63.2%); only 12.2% to 21.1% rated any domain very important. Officers seem to rate domains by how often they meet them, not by the legal consequence of error: human rights compliance, a critical domain, is rated no higher than the others. Opinion confirms the domains but cannot set the level, which comes from the law.

Figure 2.1

Officers' Rating of the Importance of Each Knowledge Domain



Note. N = 360 (359 for civil law).

Experts' View of the Required Knowledge

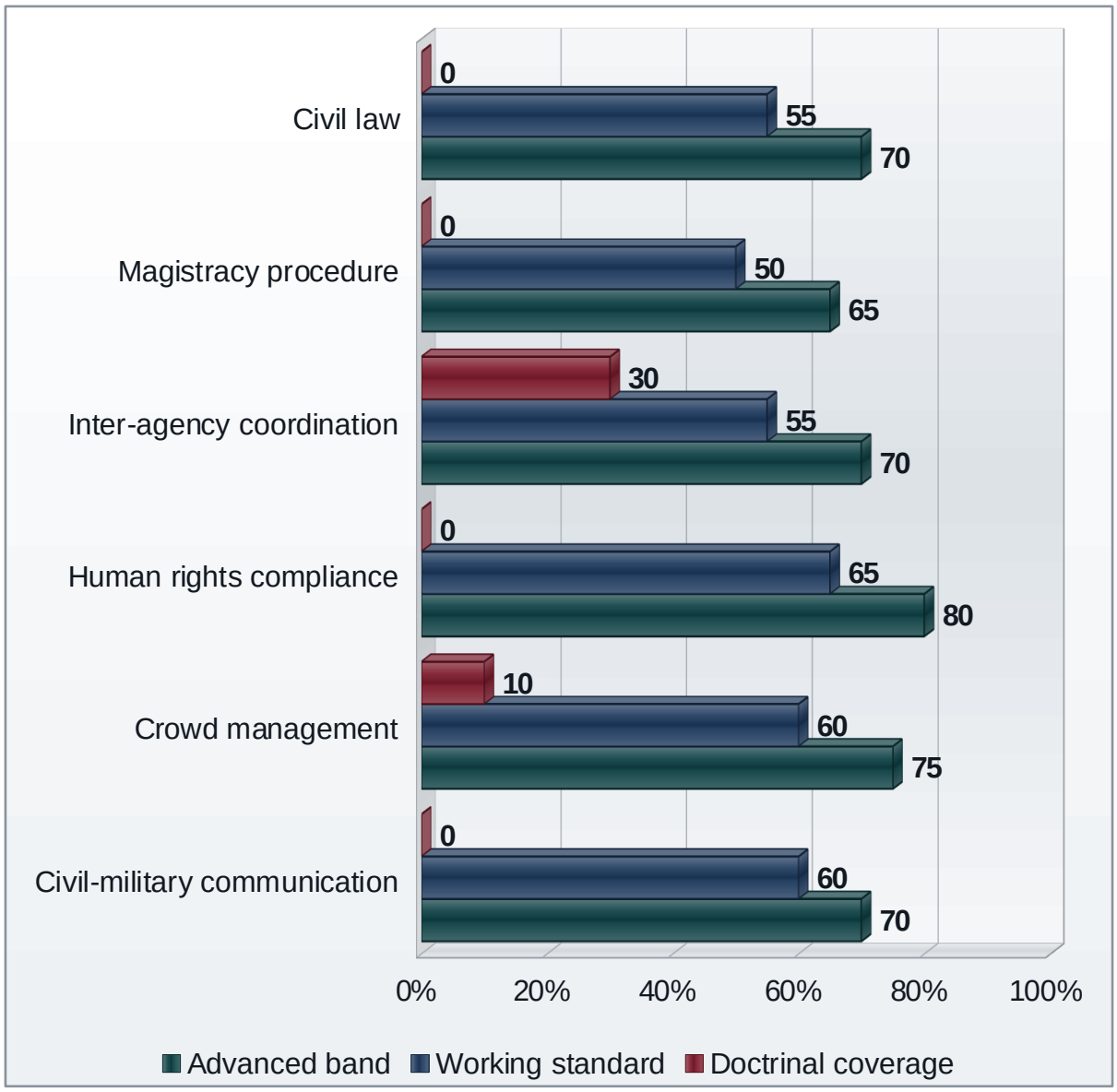
The officials who work with officers named the same domains. The DC of Sylhet listed magisterial procedure, CrPC evidence requirements and civil-military jurisdiction (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026), and the SP added arrest procedure, evidence preservation and human rights compliance (R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026). The Directors of Military Training and of Infantry added a judicial probationer's legal training and the legal threshold for dispersing an assembly (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026; M. M. H. Chowdhury, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

Coverage in Army Doctrine

MOOTW Volume I is built around disaster management and lists civil administration and law-enforcement functions only as orientation topics. Volume II trains cordon and search, roadblocks and apprehension, but not the CrPC provisions under which they must be done (ARTDOC, 2016a, 2016b). Neither covers magistracy procedure, documentation, custodial safeguards or the legal thresholds for dispersal. On the scale of the standard, doctrine covers about 30% of inter-agency coordination, 10% of crowd management and none of the other four domains, a shortfall of 25 to 65 points (Figure 2.2).

Figure 2.2

Doctrinal Coverage Against the Required Standard by Domain



Note. Researcher's coding of ARTDOC (2016a, 2016b).

International Practice

Comparable institutions teach and test before they give authority (Table 2.4). The United Kingdom treats knowledge of local authorities, the legal basis of military action and coordination as a prerequisite for military aid to the civil authorities (UK Ministry of Defence, 2017), and the United Nations runs a standing civil-military coordination course and field handbook (United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, 2015). Regional studies identify structured instruction and joint

training as what separates effective from weak coordination (Croissant et al., 2013; Ries, 2022).

Table 2.4

Benchmark Matrix of Comparable Institutions

Institution	Formal course before authority	Written rules or handbook	Standing curriculum	Joint civil-military training	Source
Executive magistrates (Bangladesh)	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	BCS Administration Academy (n.d.)
ASPs (Bangladesh Police)	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	Rtv News (2024)
United Kingdom armed forces	**Yes**	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	UK Ministry of Defence (2017)
United Nations	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	UNOCHA (2015)
United States armed forces	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	Kent (2022)
Indian Army	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	Not found	Naga People's Movement (1998); PIB (2019)
Bangladesh Army (present)	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	Survey and interviews

Note. Researcher's coding. Not found = not documented in the sources reviewed; No = absent on the evidence of this study.

Analysis

The five sources agree on what officers must know but differ on how much it matters: officers rate all domains moderately important, while the law treats two as critical. Together they fix the standard in Table 2.3: 50% to 65% of the scale maximum, and 65% in magistracy procedure for magistracy holders. A standard set from opinion would be lowest exactly where error is least forgiven, so the level was anchored to the law. Doctrine supplies between none and 30% of it, so even an officer who studied every approved text would fall short. Every comparable institution teaches and tests before it delegates, while the Army delegates first. Chapter III therefore expects knowledge to fall short in every domain and not to close with experience alone.

Summary of the Chapter

Chapter II set the expected level of knowledge: six domains, each graded by the cost of an error and set at three levels, with a working standard of 50% to 65% of the scale maximum. Army doctrine covers between none and 30% of it. This answers the first secondary question.

Chapter III
Existing State of Knowledge and Identified Gaps

General

This chapter measures officers' knowledge against the standard of Chapter II, overall and by domain, tests whether experience improves it, examines the effect of the gap and tests the hypothesis, checking survey results against the interviews, FGDs and documents.

Profile of the Respondents

Table 3.1 profiles the 360 respondents. Captains and majors, the ranks that carried most ground duties, make up 78.1%, and 90.0% had worked jointly with the civil administration.

Table 3.1

Profile of the Survey Respondents

Characteristic	Category	*n*	%
Rank	Lieutenant	66	18.3
	Captain	152	42.2
	Major	129	35.8
	Lieutenant colonel	13	3.6
Length of service	0 to 8 years	227	63.1
	8 to 15 years	98	27.2
	15 to 20 years	34	9.4
	Above 20 years	1	0.3
Deployments in aid to civil administration	1 to 3 times	273	75.8
	3 to 5 times	43	11.9
	More than 5 times	23	6.4
	Not recorded	21	5.8

Characteristic	Category	*n*	%
Institutional training on civil administration	No	206	57.2
	Yes	109	30.3
	Not sure	42	11.7
	Not recorded	3	0.8

Note. N = 360.

Reliability of the Data

All 360 responses were complete, but 80 officers gave the same answer to all nine knowledge questions. Without them knowledge changed only from 39.3% to 38.9% of the maximum and every group difference stayed above 10 points (Table B2), so the data were accepted.

Overall Level of Knowledge

Officers' Own View

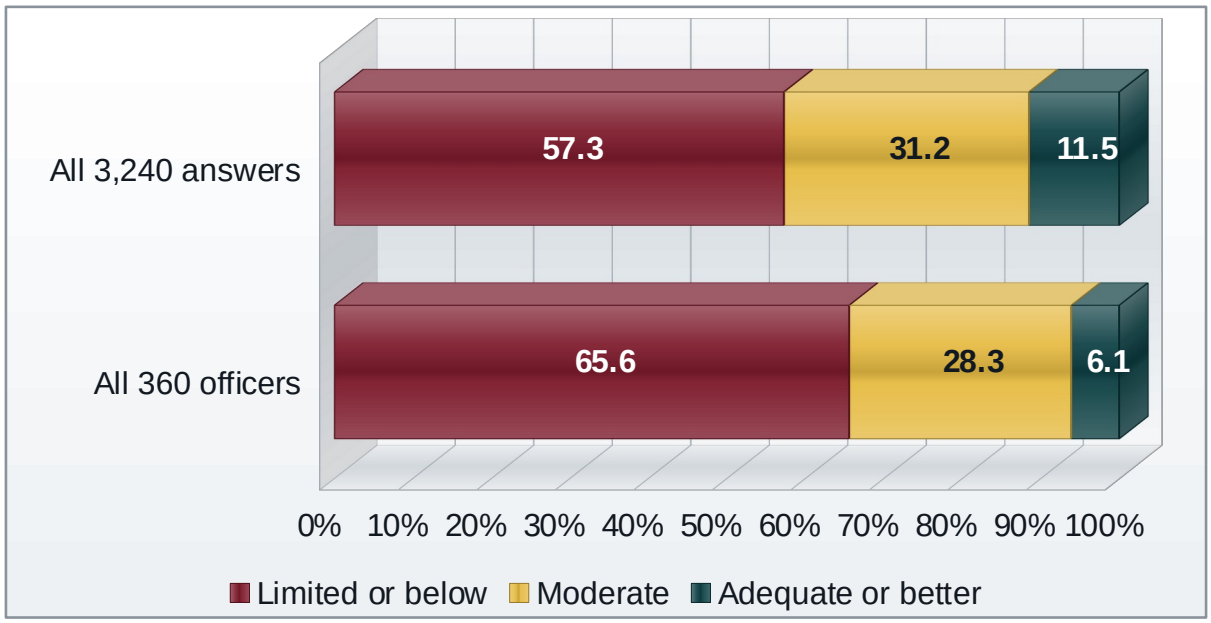
In the survey, 51.9% of officers called the knowledge gap highly significant and 39.7% moderate; only 4.4% thought present knowledge adequate. Such agreement may be a truism, so it is not used as proof. Independent sources agree: the SP rated Army units 8 to 9 out of 10 for tactical tasks but 4 to 5 for civil functions, and the DC rated preparedness 5 out of 10 (R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026; Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026).

Distribution of Ratings

Officers rated nine knowledge questions on a six-point scale. Of 3,240 answers, 57.3% were limited or very limited, 31.2% moderate and 11.5% adequate or better (Figure 3.1). The mean of all answers is 2.36, or 39.3% of the maximum, in the limited band; by officer, 65.6% have limited knowledge, 28.3% moderate and 6.1% adequate or better, and every question has a mean in the limited band (2.22 to 2.43). Junior officers learned from NCOs, adjutants and a WhatsApp summary: "that PDF was our training" (Annexure E).

Figure 3.1

Distribution of Knowledge Ratings Across Answers and Officers



Note. N = 360 officers; 3,240 answers.

Knowledge by Domain

Domain Scorecard

Table 3.2 compares knowledge in each domain with the working standard. Every domain falls short, by 11.2 points in magistracy procedure to 25.0 in human rights compliance; for officers who hold magistracy powers the magistracy gap widens to 26.2 points, the largest. Against a flat 50%, each domain still falls short, by 9.8 to 11.6 points. Figure 3.2 and Figure 3.3 show the gap against the standards.

Table 3.2

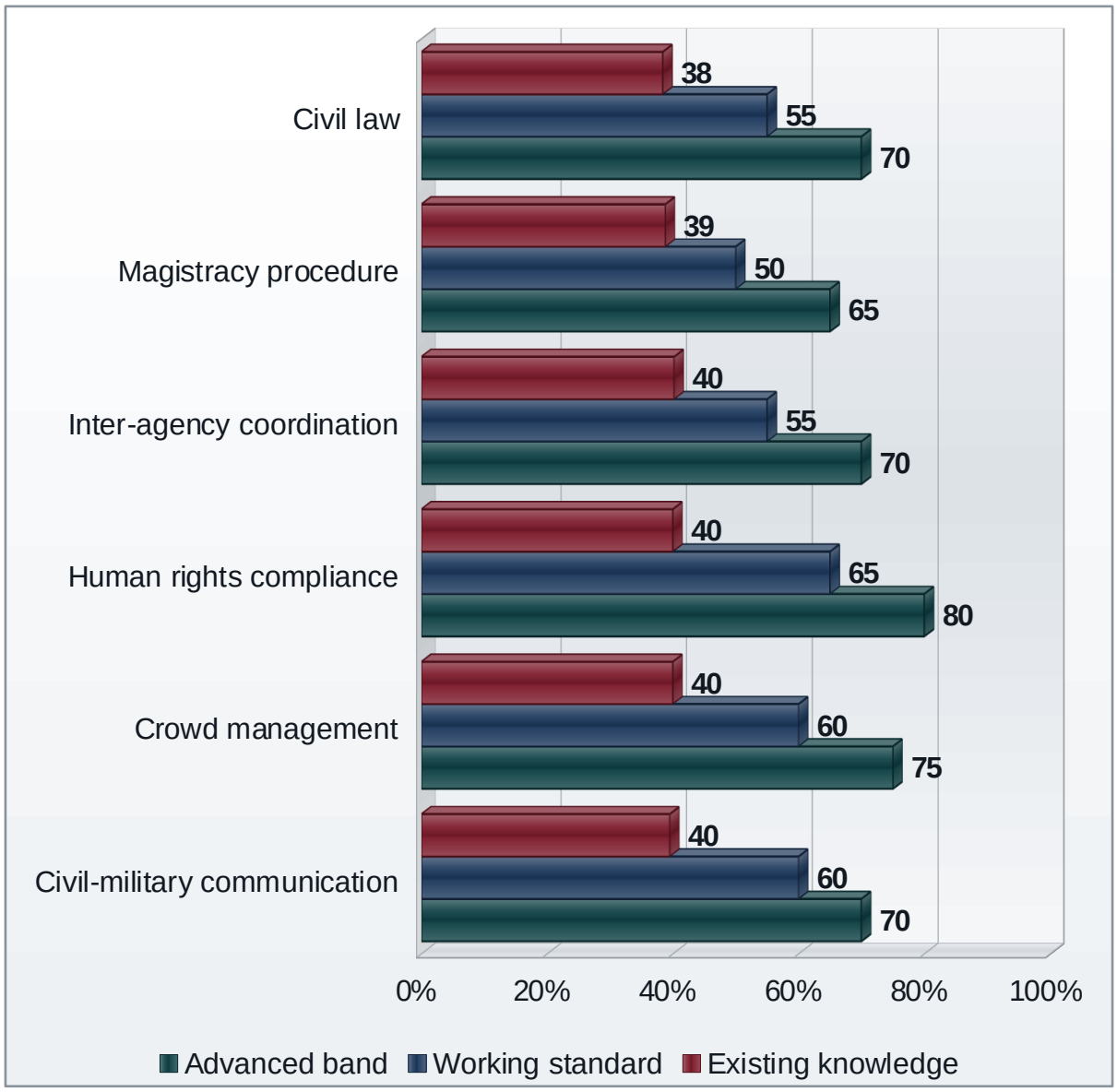
Scorecard of Knowledge, Gap and Effect by Domain

Domain	*M*	Existing (%)	Standard (%)	Gap (points)	Limited (%)	Main problem, limited vs others (%)
Civil law	2.30	38.4	55	16.6	69.7	Documentation errors 69.3 vs 41.3
Magistracy procedure	2.33	38.8	50 (65)	11.2 (26.2)	67.8	Over-reliance 68.9 vs 33.6
Inter-agency coordination	2.41	40.2	55	14.8	54.2	Friction 73.8 vs 37.0
Human rights compliance	2.40	40.0	65	25.0	65.8	Hesitation 76.4 vs 47.2
Crowd management	2.40	40.0	60	20.0	53.9	Hesitation 79.9 vs 50.6
Civil-military communication	2.37	39.5	60	20.5	59.2	Friction 71.8 vs 35.4

Note. N = 360. M = six-point mean; Existing = M as a percentage of the maximum; Standard from Table 2.3; Limited = mean below 2.67.

Figure 3.2

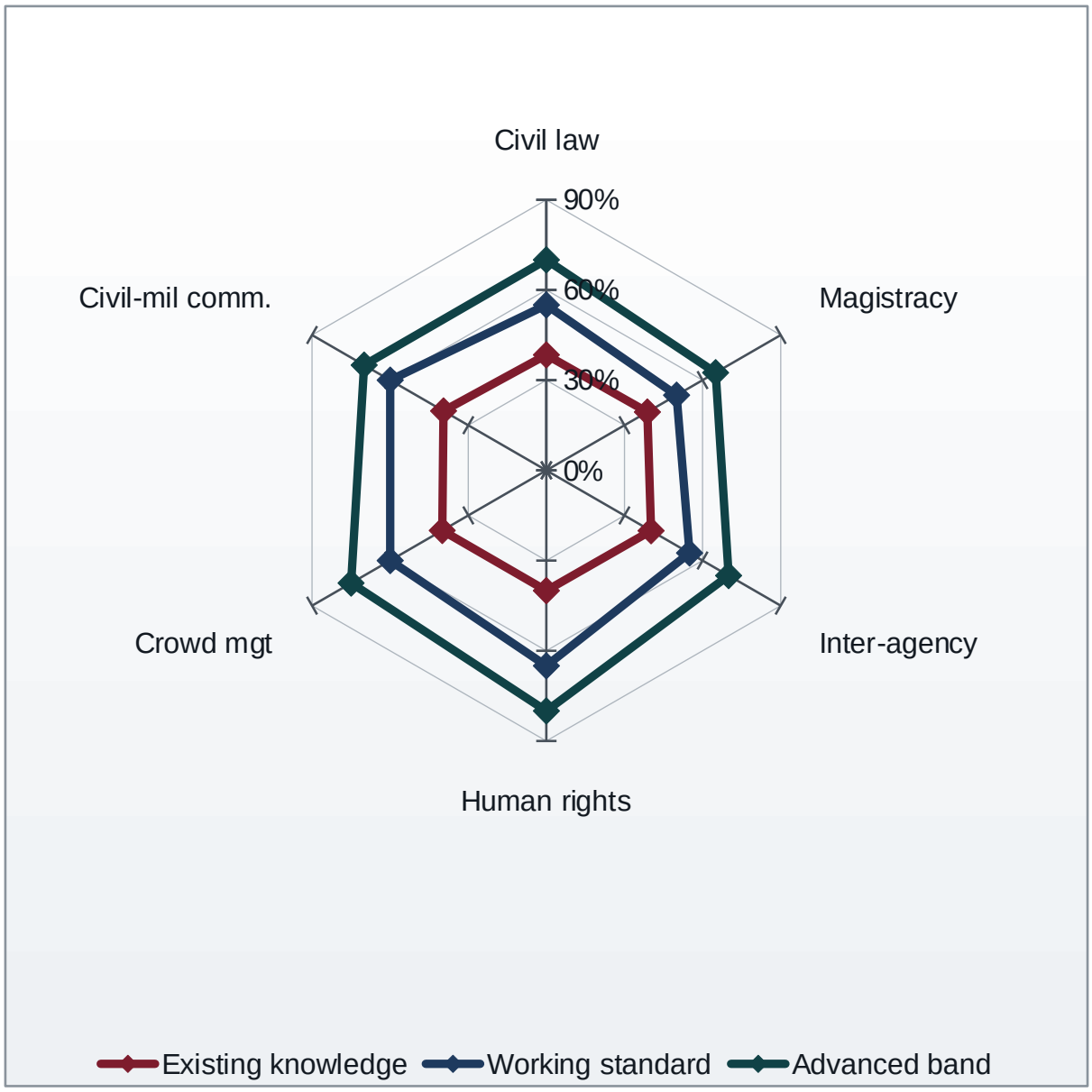
Knowledge Gap by Domain in Three Dimensions



Note. N = 360. Standards are from Table 2.3.

Figure 3.3

Knowledge Profile Radar



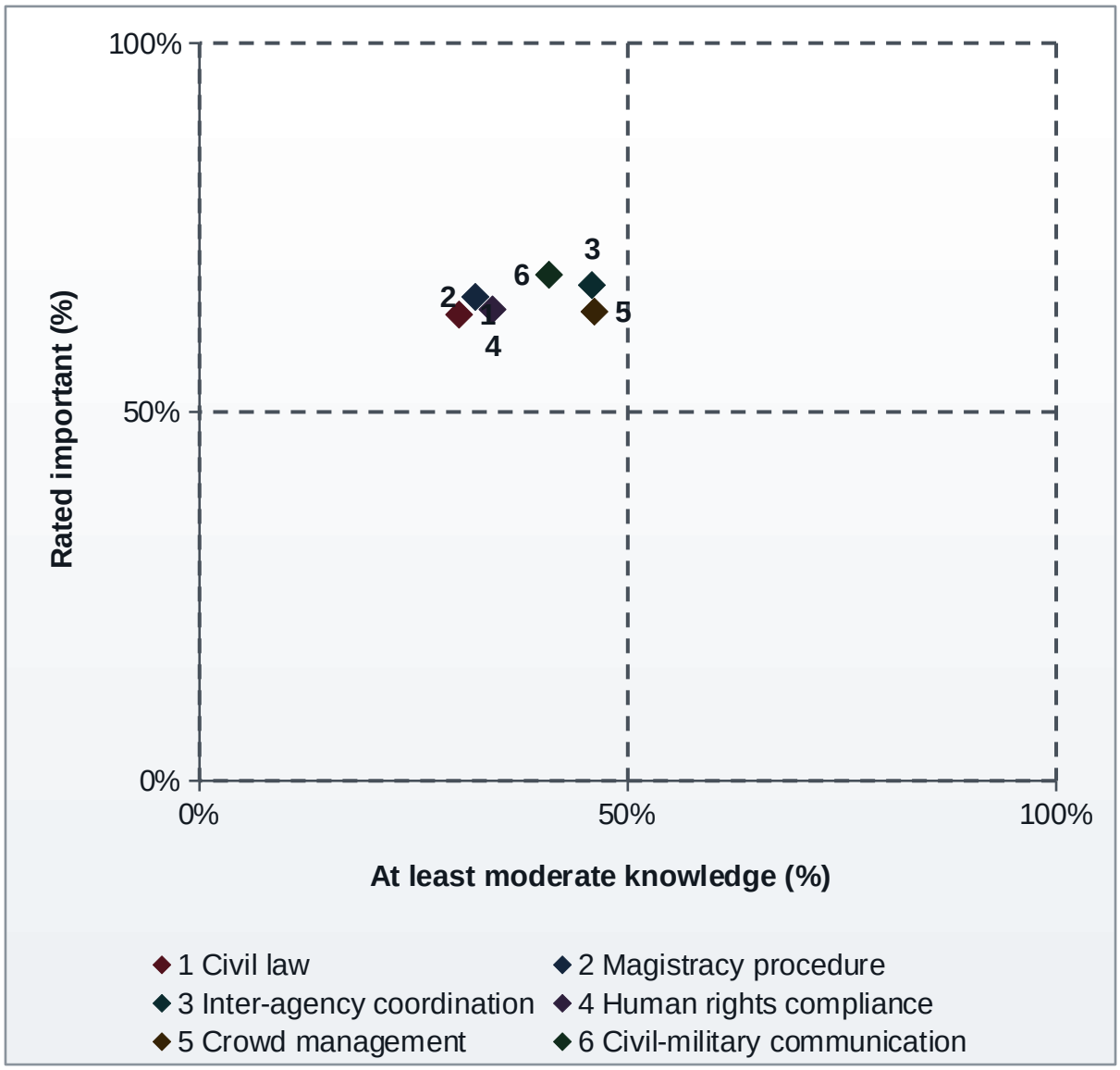
Note. N = 360. Percentages of the scale maximum.

Importance Against Knowledge

Figure 3.4 places each domain by importance and knowledge. In every domain the share rating it important exceeds the share with at least moderate knowledge, by 17.5 to 33.4 points, most in magistracy procedure (33.4) and civil law (32.9), the domains used most under the 2024 powers. All six fall in the quadrant of high importance and low knowledge: officers value the knowledge but do not hold it.

Figure 3.4

Importance and Knowledge Priority Quadrant



Note. N = 360. Top-left = high importance, low knowledge.

Areas with Larger Gaps

Table 3.3 combines how likely an error is, from the share of officers with limited knowledge, with how serious it would be. Magistracy procedure, human rights compliance and civil law fall in the high-risk zone, and the first two are examined here.

Table 3.3

Risk Matrix of the Six Knowledge Domains

Likelihood (officers limited)	1 Negligible	2 Minor	3 Moderate	4 Severe	5 Critical
5 Almost certain (70%+)					
4 Likely (60% to 69%)				Civil law	Magistracy procedure Human rights
3 Possible (50% to 59%)			Inter-agency	Crowd management Civil-military comm.	
2 Unlikely (40% to 49%)					
1 Rare (below 40%)					

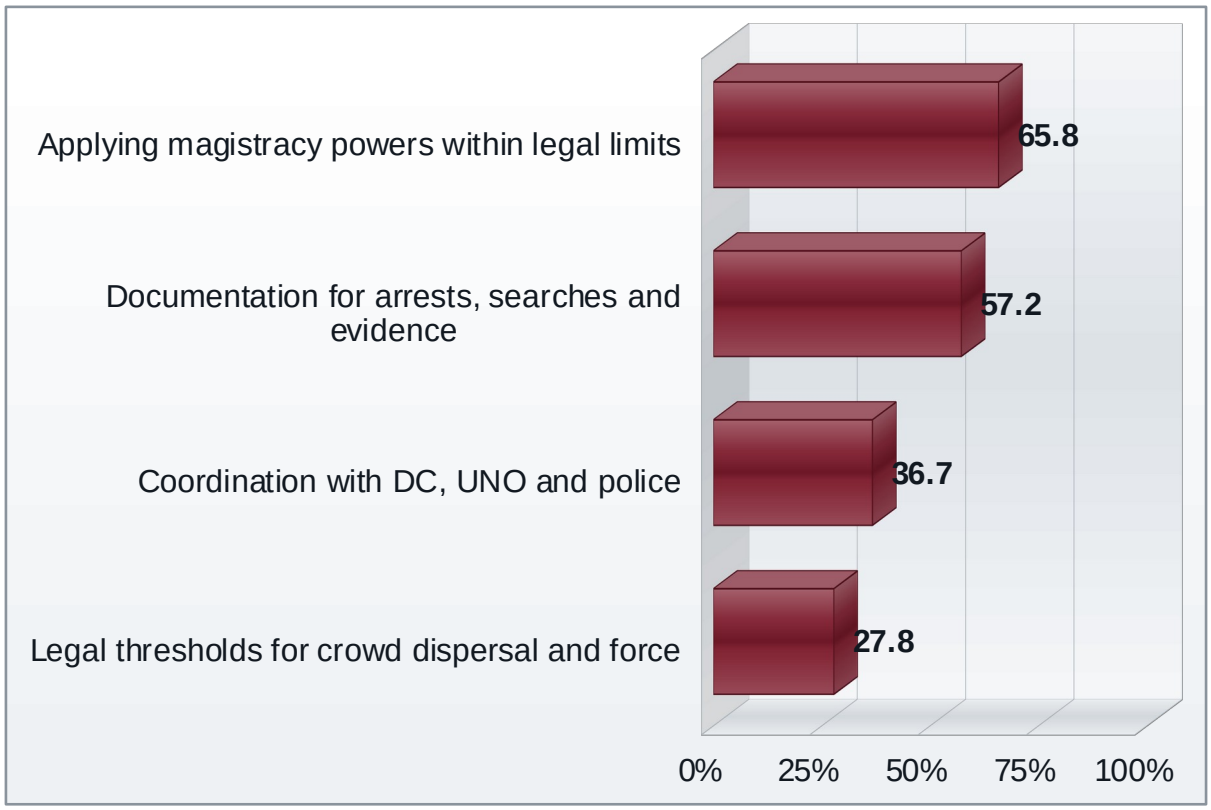
Note. Likelihood from Table 3.2; consequence from Table 2.3.

Magistracy Procedure

Magistracy procedure is critical because it is where an officer exercises legal power directly. On this question 63.6% rated themselves limited or below. Asked where they feel least confident, 65.8% named applying magistracy powers within legal limits and 57.2% documentation for arrests, searches and evidence (Figure 3.5). Among officers with limited knowledge in this domain, 68.9% report over-reliance on magistrates or police often or always, against 33.6% of others. In Sylhet detentions by troops were overturned and the High Court ordered scrutiny (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026), and a company commander recalled exercising judicial power after "maybe two hours of lecture" (S. M. M. Islam, personal communication, July 22, 2026).

Figure 3.5

Topics on Which Officers Feel Least Confident



Note. N = 360; more than one topic allowed.

Human Rights Compliance

Human rights compliance is also critical, and its standard is the highest (65%), so its gap is the largest for officers in general (25.0 points). The DC observed force used in crowd control "without adequate de-escalation" (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026), and the SP to female detainees held without female custody staff (R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026). Hesitation is reported often or always by 76.4% of officers with limited knowledge here, against 47.2% of others. Ain o Salish Kendra recorded 38 extrajudicial killings in 2025 against 21 in 2024 (New Age, 2025), and a single death in custody, as in Cumilla, can damage trust in a whole deployment (Chowdhury, 2025).

Experience Versus Knowledge

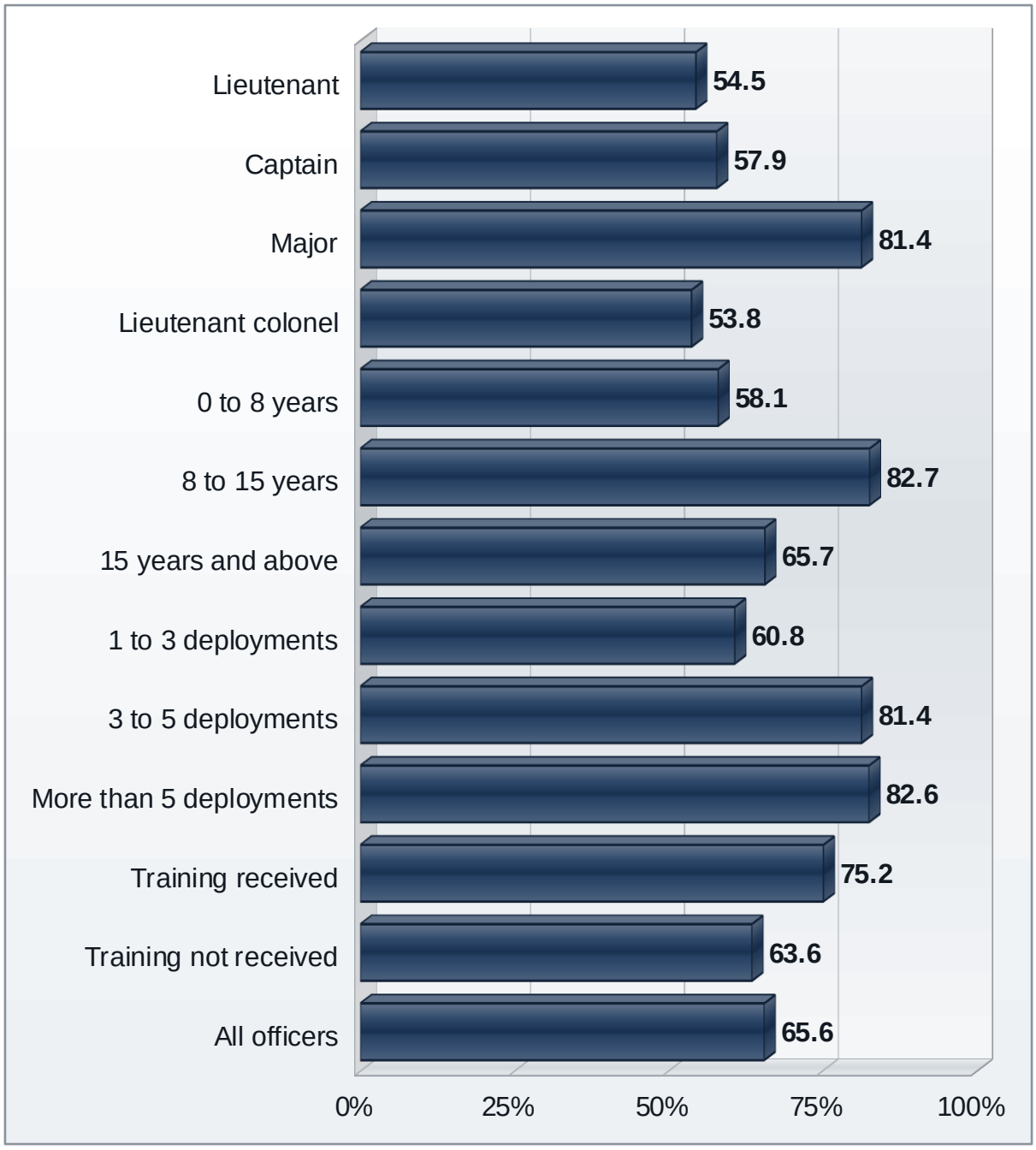
Rank, Service and Deployments

If experience built knowledge, senior and more deployed officers would know more, but Figure 3.6 shows the opposite, and Figure 3.7 shows the gradient. The share

with limited knowledge rises from 54.5% of lieutenants and 57.9% of captains to 81.4% of majors; from 58.1% of officers with up to 8 years' service to 82.7% of those with 8 to 15 years; and from 60.8% with one to three deployments to 81.4% and 82.6% with more. Experience may build routine without a legal base (Becker, 1964), or officers who faced more real legal decisions may be more aware of their gaps; either way it brings familiarity, not legal knowledge. The DC and SP found senior officers better informed and the FGDs credited earlier duties with some help (Table 3.7), so the finding is "experience is not enough", not "experience does not help".

Figure 3.6

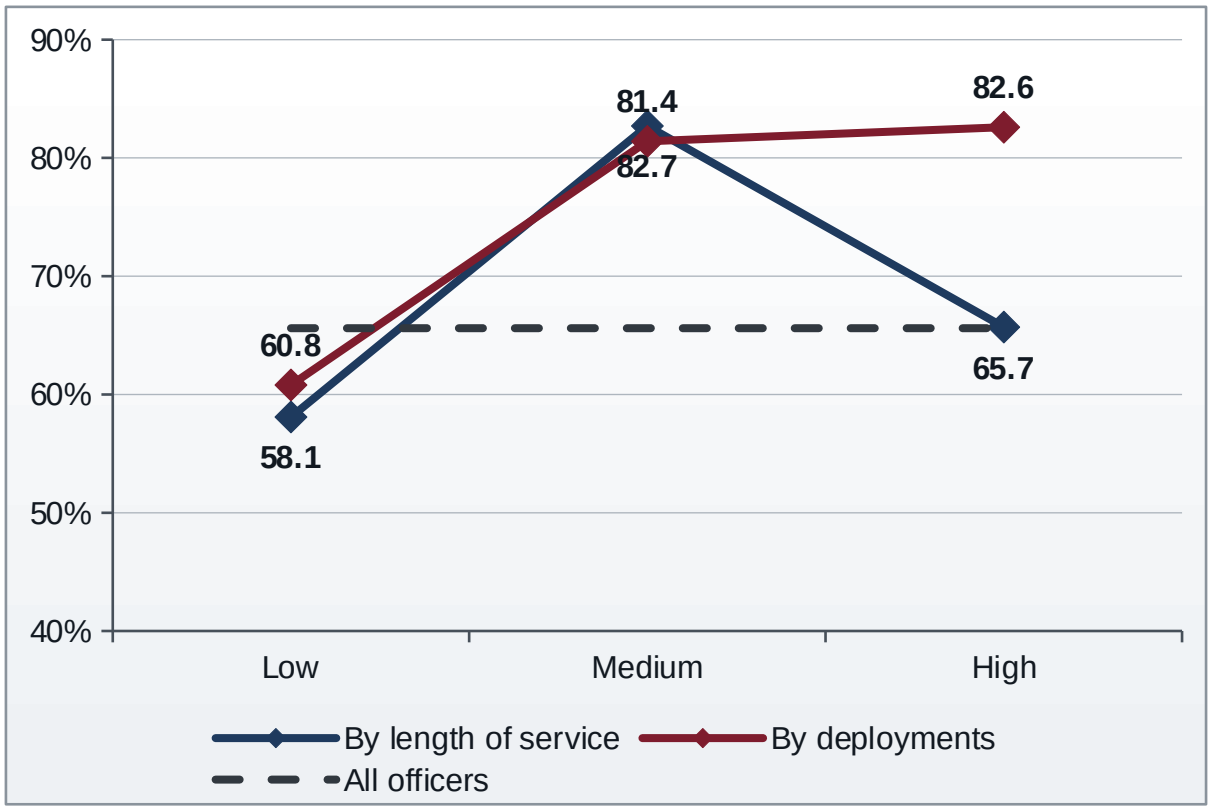
Share of Officers with Limited Knowledge by Rank, Service, Deployments and Training



Note. N = 360. Read groups of fewer than 25 officers with caution.

Figure 3.7

Experience Gradient



Note. Low, medium, high = 0 to 8, 8 to 15, 15+ years; 1 to 3, 3 to 5, 5+ deployments. Dashed line = all officers (65.6%).

Rank by Domain

Table 3.4 shows that majors score lowest in every domain, from 2.05 in civil law to 2.17 in human rights compliance. Majors usually command companies, where most magistracy duties were performed, so the rank that needs the knowledge most holds the least.

Table 3.4

Rank by Domain Heat Map

Rank	n	Civil law	Magistracy	Inter-agency	Human rights	Crowd mgt	Civil-mil comm.	Problems (%)
Lieutenant	66	2.50	2.55	2.65	2.74	2.73	2.65	**72.7**
Captain	152	2.45	2.43	2.61	2.46	2.47	2.49	**79.6**
Major	129	**2.05**	**2.09**	**2.06**	2.17	2.15	**2.06**	**93.8**
Lieutenant colonel	13	**2.12**	2.38	2.38	2.31	2.46	2.62	**84.6**
All officers	360	2.30	2.33	2.41	2.40	2.40	2.37	**83.6**

Note. Domain means on the six-point scale. Dark red = below 2.15.

Present Training

Officers who received institutional training score lower (2.13) than those who did not (2.43), in all six domains and most in magistracy procedure (2.02 against 2.45); 75.2% of trained officers have limited knowledge. Present training, mostly short briefings, seems to make officers aware of the gap without closing it: "briefings alone are not enough" (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

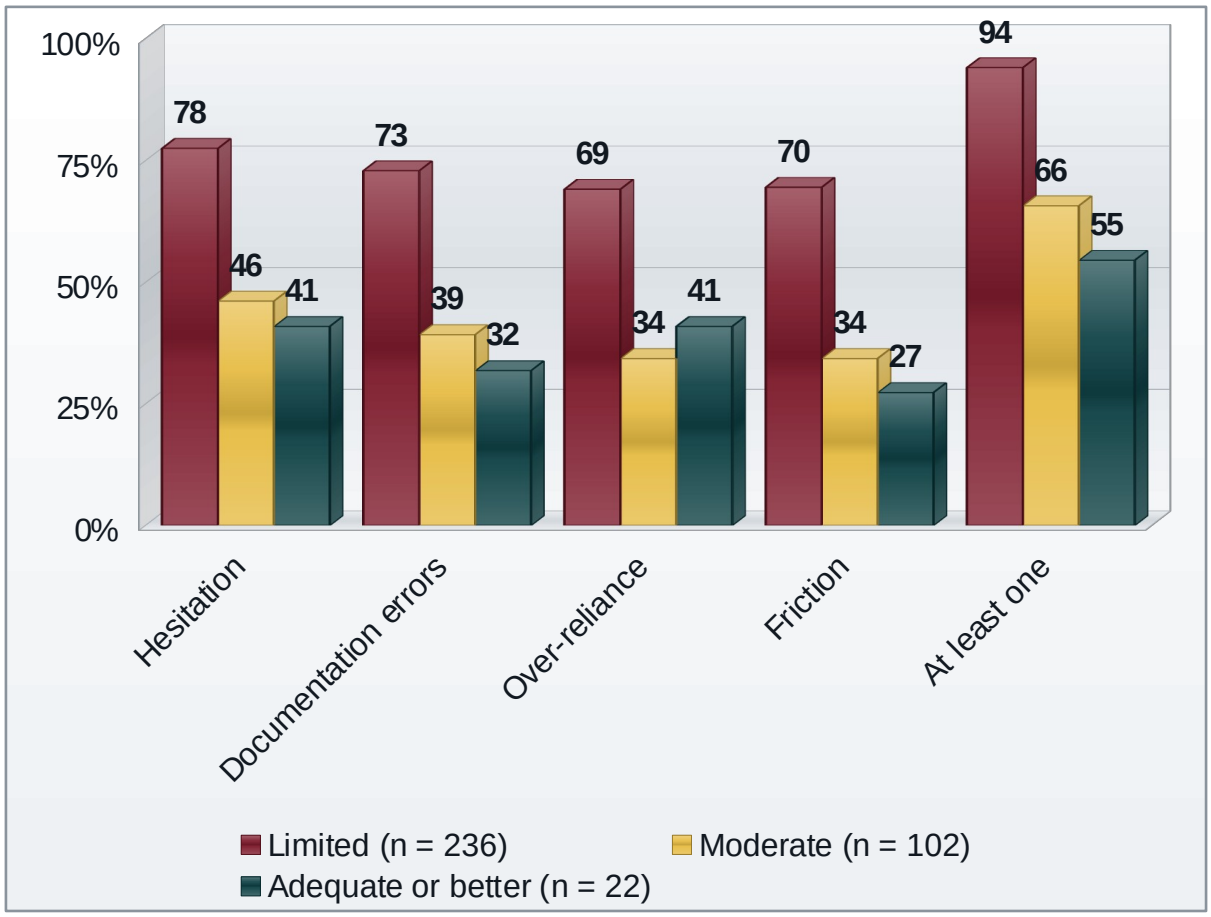
Effect of the Gap on Performance

Problems by Level of Knowledge

Officers with limited knowledge admit hesitating for lack of knowledge more often (66.9%) than those at the moderate (47.1%) or adequate (22.7%) levels. Figure 3.8 shows how often each group meets the four problems: officers with limited knowledge meet each 32.3 to 36.4 points more often than the rest, on average often (M = 3.95) against sometimes (M = 3.36), a significant difference ($z = 6.13$ to 6.64, $p < .001$). The field record agrees: the SP reported arrests without recorded grounds and no chain of custody, the DC searches without warrants and detentions beyond legal limits (Annexure D), and a company commander called the 2024 outcome "luck, not design" (Annexure E).

Figure 3.8

Problems on the Ground by Level of Knowledge in Three Dimensions



Test of the Hypothesis

The decision rule of Chapter I was applied (Table 3.5). All three conditions are met by a wide margin, so H0 is rejected and H1 accepted: officers' knowledge is inadequate and the shortfall lowers their efficiency. The result holds without the 80 uniform responders (Table B2). Table 3.6 adds effect sizes and group tests: officers with limited knowledge have about four times the odds of meeting each problem, and rank, service and deployments are significantly linked to limited knowledge, but not in the direction that "experience is enough" implies. The interviews and FGDs agree with the survey on three of the four main findings and partly on the fourth (Table 3.7).

Table 3.5

Test of the Hypothesis Against the Decision Rule

Condition	Evidence	Required	Met
1. Mean knowledge below the working standard in every domain	38.4% to 40.2% against standards of 50% to 65%; gaps of 11.2 to 25.0 points	All six domains	Yes
2. More than half of officers have limited knowledge	65.6% of officers	Above 50%	Yes
3. Officers with limited knowledge meet each problem more often, and significantly so	Differences of 32.3 to 36.4 points; z = 6.13 to 6.64, p < .001	At least 10 points on each problem; p < .05	Yes

Note. Limited (n = 236) against others (n = 124); calculations at Annexure B.

Table 3.6

Hypothesis Test Results Panel

Test	Groups compared	Statistic	p	Effect size
Does limited knowledge raise the problems? Two-proportion z-tests				
Hesitation	Limited (236) vs others (124)	z = 6.17	< .001	h = 0.68; OR = 4.18
Documentation errors	Limited vs others	z = 6.47	< .001	h = 0.72; OR = 4.41
Over-reliance	Limited vs others	z = 6.13	< .001	h = 0.69; OR = 4.06
Friction	Limited vs others	z = 6.64	< .001	h = 0.75; OR = 4.61
Does experience close the gap? Chi-square tests against limited knowledge				
Rank	Four ranks (N = 360)	$\chi^2(3) = 22.62$	< .001	V = 0.25
Service	Three bands (N = 360)	$\chi^2(2) = 18.20$	< .001	V = 0.22
Deployments	Three bands (N = 339)	$\chi^2(2) = 10.31$	.006	V = 0.17
Training	Trained vs untrained (N = 315)	$\chi^2(1) = 4.41$	.036	V = 0.12

Note. h = Cohen's h; OR = odds ratio; V = Cramer's V. Computed from counts in this paper; read the rank test with caution.

Table 3.7

Evidence Convergence Matrix

Finding	Survey	Senior commanders	DC and SP	FGDs	Documents	Strength
Knowledge of the civil side is limited	●	●	●	●	●	**Strong**
Magistracy powers and documentation are weakest	●	●	●	●	●	**Strong**
Experience alone does not close the gap	●	●	○	○	–	**Moderate**
The gap causes problems on the ground	●	●	●	●	○	**Strong**
The causes are institutional	●	●	●	●	●	**Strong**

Note. ● = supports; ○ = partly; – = not addressed. Strong = four or more sources.

Analysis

The findings say more than that knowledge is low. First, the gap is uniform: the nine questions differ by only 0.21 points and no domain reaches the standard, which points to a common cause in the system, not to weak individuals. Second, the gap grows where it should shrink: majors, officers with 8 to 15 years' service and the most deployed are most often limited, so those who use the powers most are least prepared. Third, the gap has a cost: a difference of 32 to 36 points is too large and consistent to be chance, and civil officials in Sylhet described the same faults independently. Trained officers score lower, so short briefings expose the gap without closing it. These findings support Becker's (1964) view that knowledge follows investment and point to the institution in Chapter IV.

Summary of the Chapter

Chapter III measured knowledge against the standard: 39.3% of the maximum, with 65.6% of officers limited. Every domain falls short by 11.2 to 25.0 points, and by 26.2 in magistracy procedure for magistracy holders. Rank, service, deployments and present training do not close the gap, and officers with limited knowledge meet each problem 32 to 36 points more often. H0 was rejected and H1 accepted, answering the second secondary question.

Chapter IV

Factors Affecting the Civil Administration Knowledge of Officers

General

Chapter III showed that knowledge does not improve with rank, service or deployments, pointing to causes within the system. This chapter identifies them, tests each against more than one source and shows how they reinforce each other.

Identifying the Factors of the Knowledge Gap

Five factors were put to officers and a sixth emerged from Chapter III. Each surveyed factor was accepted by at least 70% of officers (Table 4.1), but agreement at this level approaches a truism, so each was also tested against a hard indicator from the survey, the doctrine review or the interviews, and against the four groups of interviewees and FGD participants. Officers with limited knowledge agree more strongly (96.2%) than others (66.1%). Figure 4.1 classifies the factors.

Table 4.1

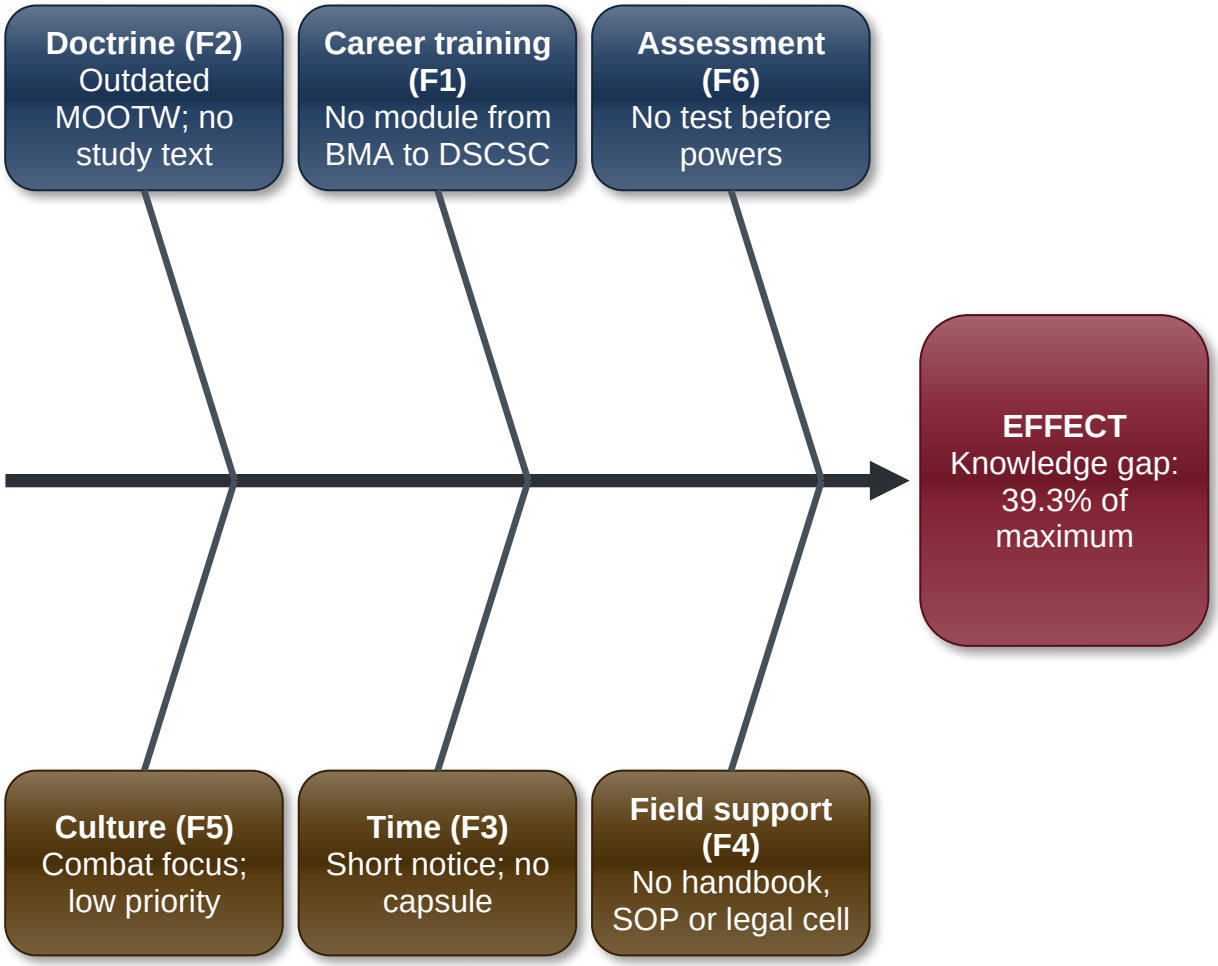
Evidence for the Six Factors

Factor	Hard indicator	Agreed (%)	Groups raising it (of 4)
F1 No module in career courses	78.9% say courses cover it poorly or not at all	79.4	4
F2 Outdated doctrine, no study material	Doctrine covers 0% to 30% of the standard (Chapter II)	75.8	4
F3 Short notice, no pre-deployment training	74.2% say preparation time is not assured	74.7	4
F4 No field reference or legal support	No issued handbook or SOP	70.6	4
F5 Low priority, combat-focused culture	83.3% say culture gives little or no emphasis	71.1	4
F6 Reliance on experience, no test	81.4% to 82.7% of the most experienced are limited	Tested in Chapter III	3

Note. Based on the survey (N = 360) and Annexures D and E.

Figure 4.1

Fishbone Diagram of the Knowledge Gap



Note. Researcher's own construct from Table 4.1.

Factors Affecting the Knowledge

Factor 1: No Civil Administration Training in Career Courses

Asked how well basic career courses cover civil administration, 38.6% answered "not at all" and 40.3% "very poorly" or "poorly"; only 1.1% answered "well". The Director of Military Training called this a training-to-task mismatch: syllabi prepare officers for war but "spend very little time on the administrative skills that ACP actually demands" (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

Factor 2: Outdated Doctrine and No Study Material

Training is conducted against doctrine, but the 2016 MOOTW volumes omit the legal side (Chapter II), so instructors have no approved text. In the survey 75.8% agree

that the lack of precise study material contributes to the gap, and the battalion adjutant prepared the unit's formats and registers alone (Annexure E).

Factor 3: Short Notice and No Mandatory Pre-Deployment Training

Deployments usually come at short notice. Only 25.8% of officers said adequate time is generally given for legal and administrative preparation; 45.6% said "sometimes" and 28.6% "no". In all, 74.7% agree that the lack of a mandatory pre-deployment capsule contributes to the gap. One company commander received "maybe two hours of lecture" before exercising judicial power in September 2024 (S. M. M. Islam, personal communication, July 22, 2026).

Factor 4: No Field Reference Material or Legal Support

In the field an officer unsure of the law has no issued reference; 70.6% agree that the lack of field handbooks and standing operating procedures (SOPs) contributes to the gap. Legal advice is thin: the Commander of 52 Infantry Brigade reported that the brigade's small legal cell was stretched across several units (S. Rahman, personal communication, July 14, 2026), and a captain seeking advice before a first mobile court duty was told, "I am reading the same document you are" (A. A. Ouikko, personal communication, July 20, 2026).

Factor 5: Low Priority and a Combat-Focused Training Culture

The training culture also sustains the gap. In the survey 71.1% agree that differing views of senior leadership on the subject's priority contribute to it, and 83.3% say the culture gives civil administration "not at all" or "to a small extent" emphasis. Commanders are assessed mainly on tactical readiness, so preparation depends on initiative: "that is Shafiq's system, not the Army's system; when I hand over, it goes with me" (Md. S. Islam, personal communication, July 22, 2026).

Factor 6: Reliance on Experience Without Any Test

The institution assumed that officers would learn the civil side through experience and personal interest. Chapter III showed that this fails: 81.4% to 82.7% of the most experienced groups have limited knowledge. Without an early foundation experience adds routine, not legal knowledge, and with no test the gap stays hidden until it appears on the ground. As the Commander of 52 Infantry Brigade put it, "certification must come before delegation" (S. Rahman, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

How the Factors Reinforce Each Other

The factors form a cycle in which each sustains the next (Figure 4.2). Outdated doctrine keeps the subject out of career courses; the absent module signals low priority; low priority leaves units without pre-deployment training when short-notice tasks arrive; without field references or legal support officers learn on the job; and because nothing is tested, lessons never return to doctrine. Table 4.2 shows that low priority (F5), outdated doctrine (F2) and the missing module (F1) drive the cycle, short notice (F3) and missing field support (F4) are mostly results, and the missing test (F6) is the critical link.

Table 4.2

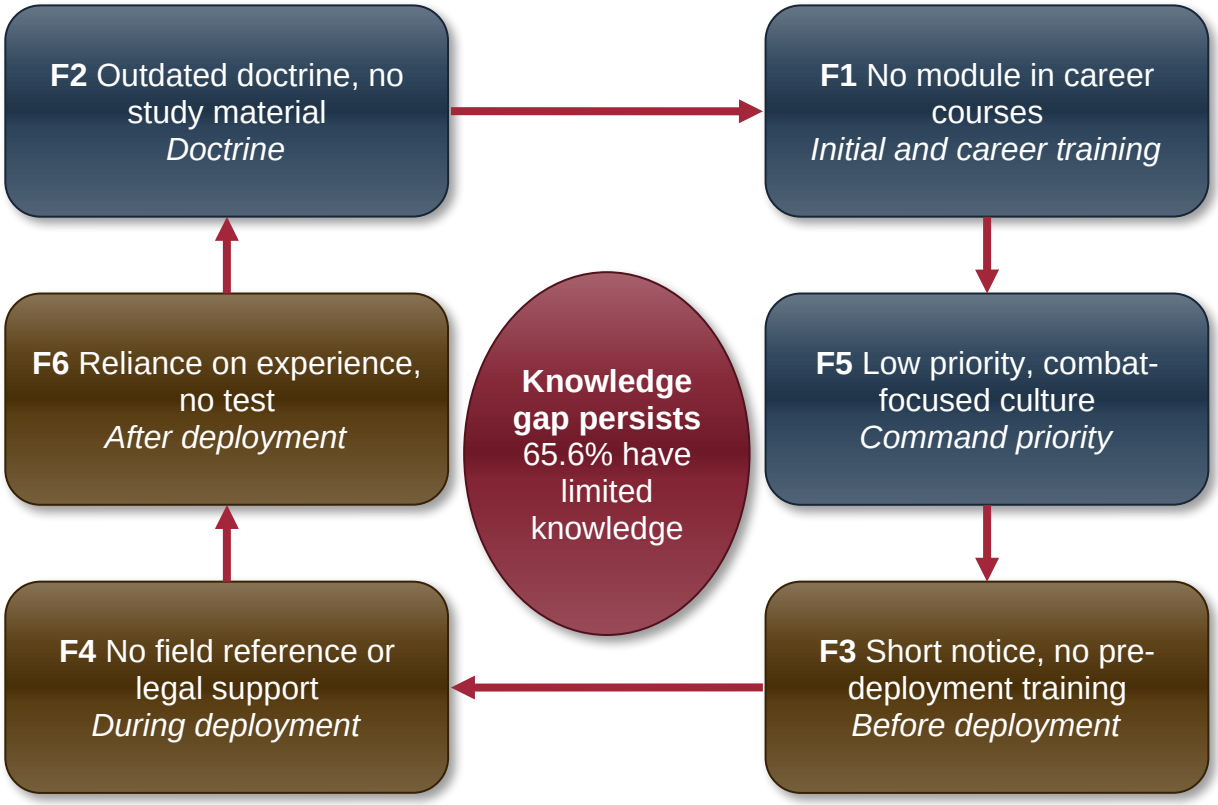
Cross-Impact Matrix of the Six Factors

Influence of (row) on (column)	F1	F2	F3	F4	F5	F6	Active sum	Role
F1 No module		1	2	1	**3**	2	**9**	**Driver**
F2 Outdated doctrine	**3**		1	**3**	1	1	**9**	**Driver**
F3 Short notice	0	0		1	1	2	**4**	**Result**
F4 No field support	0	0	0		0	**3**	**3**	**Result**
F5 Low priority	2	2	**3**	2		1	**10**	**Driver**
F6 No test	1	**3**	0	1	2		**7**	**Critical link**
Passive sum	**6**	**6**	**6**	**8**	**7**	**9**		

Note. Researcher's assessment: 0 = none, 1 = weak, 2 = moderate, 3 = strong.

Figure 4.2

The Cycle of Factors That Sustains the Knowledge Gap

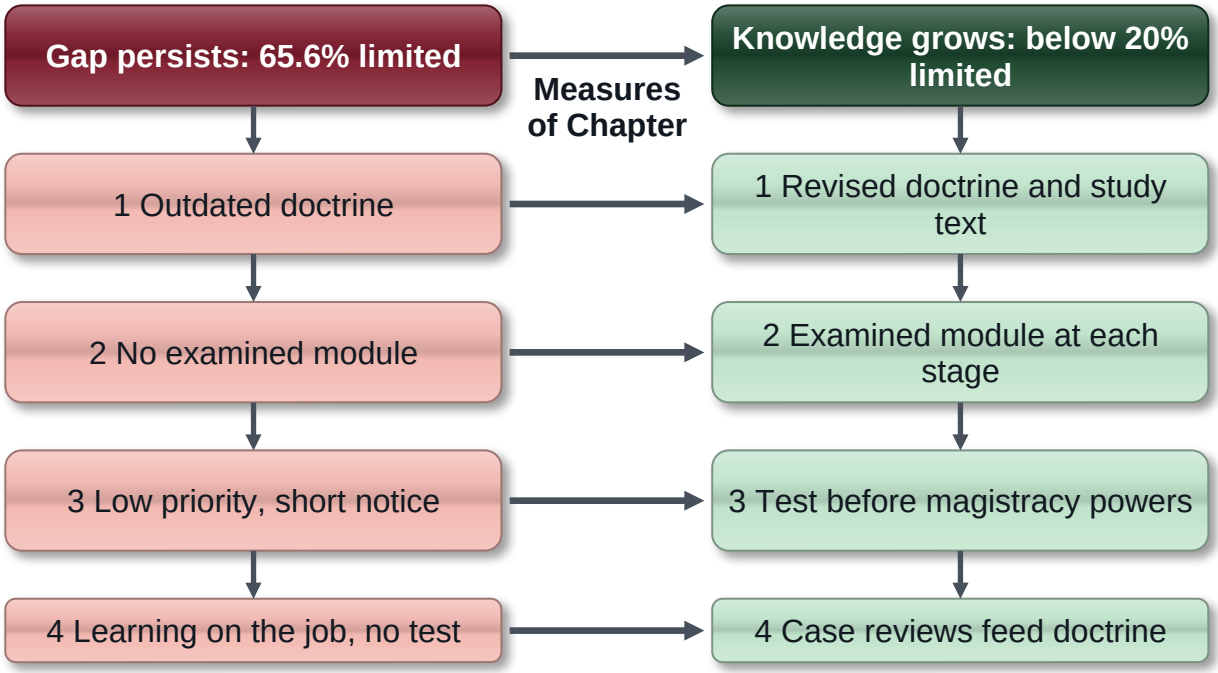


Analysis

The six factors explain the pattern of Chapter III. No factor depends on the individual officer, so the gap appears in every rank and domain; the cycle has no test and no feedback, so experience cannot break it, which is why majors and the most deployed officers know least. Short-term measures such as briefings act only on F3, and the lower scores of trained officers show they cannot work alone. A lasting remedy must act at several points at once, as comparable institutions do by pairing teaching with testing (Table 2.4). Figure 4.3 sets the present vicious cycle against the virtuous cycle proposed in Chapter V.

Figure 4.3

From Vicious to Virtuous Cycle



Note. Researcher's own construct from Figure 4.2 and Table 5.2.

Summary of the Chapter

Chapter IV identified six institutional factors: no module in career courses, outdated doctrine, short notice, no field reference or legal support, low priority in a combat-focused culture, and reliance on experience without any test. Each is supported by the survey, a hard indicator and at least three of four groups interviewed, and together they form a cycle that experience cannot break. This answers the third secondary question.

Chapter V
Conclusions and Recommendations

General

This chapter answers the research questions, states how the hypothesis was proved, proposes ways forward, concludes, makes recommendations and notes the scope for further research.

Answers to the Research Questions

Table 5.1 traces each research question to its finding, evidence, factor and recommendation.

Table 5.1

Research Traceability Matrix

Research question	Key finding	Evidence	Factor	Recommendation
Primary: is knowledge adequate?	No; H0 rejected, H1 accepted	Table 3.5; Table 3.6	All	All (a to k)
1. What knowledge is required?	Six domains; standard 50% to 65%; doctrine 0% to 30%	Table 2.3; Figure 2.2	F2	f, a
2. What is the existing state?	39.3% of maximum; 65.6% limited; gap 11.2 to 25.0 points	Table 3.2, Table 3.4	F6	c, h
3. What factors affect the gap?	Six institutional factors in a cycle	Table 4.1; Table 4.2	F1 to F6	d, e, g, i, j, k
4. What measures are recommended?	Eleven measures; every factor covered	Table 5.2, Table 5.3	All	a to k

Note. Researcher's own construct; letters as in the recommendations.

Proof of the Hypothesis

The hypothesis was tested in Chapter III against the decision rule of Chapter I. Knowledge fell below the standard in all six domains, 65.6% of officers had limited knowledge, and those with limited knowledge met each problem 32.3 to 36.4 points more often ($z = 6.13$ to 6.64, $p < .001$). All three conditions were met, so H0 was rejected and H1 accepted (Table 3.5); the result held without the uniform responders (Table B2) and the interviews and FGDs supported it (Table 3.7).

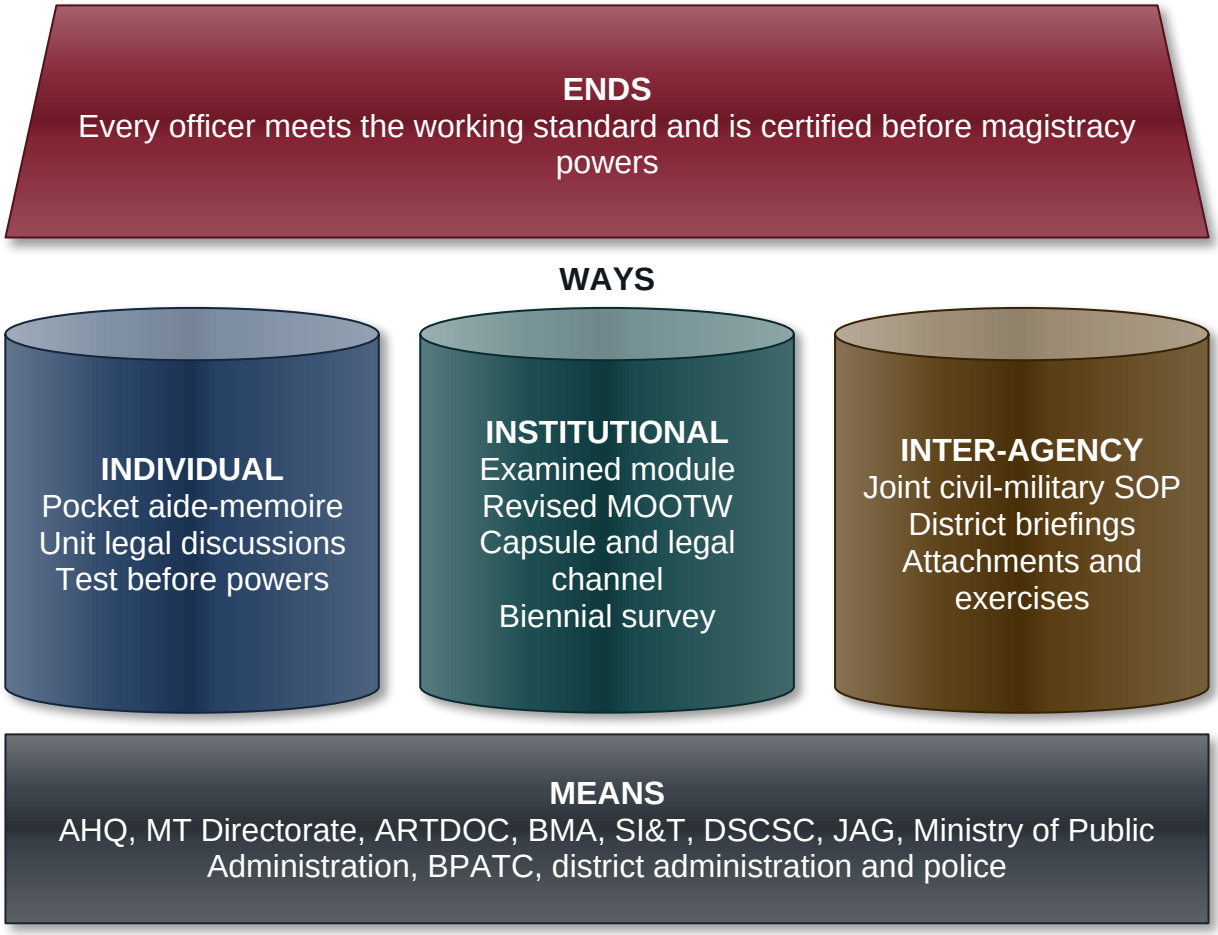
Ways Forward

Principles of the Ways Forward

The ways forward follow four principles. First, knowledge must come before authority, as theory and comparable institutions (Table 2.4) require. Second, every measure must act on a factor identified in Chapter IV. Third, measures must use existing institutions and training cycles. Fourth, progress must be measured against the baseline of this study. Figure 5.1 states them as ends, ways and means.

Figure 5.1

Ends, Ways and Means of the Proposed Reform



Lessons from Comparable Institutions

Learn before authority. Civil executive magistrates complete a 151-day law course, and police officers about a year of basic training, before using such powers (Bangladesh Civil Service Administration Academy, n.d.; Rtv News, 2024); Army officers should likewise be taught and certified first. *Keep rules short and binding.* India's "Dos and Don'ts" for troops in internal security were upheld by its Supreme Court (Naga People's Movement of Human Rights v. Union of India, 1998), and its Army Headquarters later created a human rights section (Press Information Bureau, 2019). *Teach in phases.* The United States combines an online course with a short residential course (Kent, 2022).

A Career-Long Knowledge Pathway

Figure 5.2 turns these lessons into a pathway from BMA through the arms and services schools, the School of Infantry and Tactics (SI&T), captain-level courses and DSCSC to pre-deployment, deployment and review. Each stage adds knowledge and

a check, and case reviews and a repeated survey feed back into doctrine, reversing the cycle of Figure 4.2.

Figure 5.2

Proposed Knowledge Pathway for Aid to Civil Administration Duties



Note. Researcher's own construct from Chapters II to IV and Table 2.4.

Proposed Measures

Table 5.2 lists eleven measures, each linked to the factor it breaks and the finding it answers; Table 5.3 shows that every factor is met by at least two measures, and Figure 5.3 ranks the measures by impact and effort.

Table 5.2

Proposed Measures, Factors Addressed, Findings, Support and Priority

Measure	Factors	Finding addressed	Support (%) or source	Priority
Individual level				
1. Pocket aide-memoire on law and formats	F2, F4	57.2% least confident in documentation	Interviews; Indian practice	Immediate
2. Unit legal discussions; case reviews	F5, F6	Experienced officers most often limited	71.1	Immediate
3. Test in magisterial procedure before magistracy powers	F6	63.6% limited on magistracy powers	Interviews	Immediate
Institutional level				
4. Formation-level legal advisory channel	F4	Brigade legal cell stretched	75.3	Immediate
5. Mandatory pre-deployment legal capsule	F3	74.2%: time not assured	75.0	Immediate
6. Revised MOOTW with a civil administration volume	F2	Doctrine covers 0% to 30%	Doctrine review	Short term
7. Compulsory, examined module at every career stage	F1, F5	78.9%: courses cover it poorly or not at all	76.9	Short term
8. Survey repeated every two years	F6	No prior measure	Study design	Medium term
Inter-agency level				

Measure	Factors	Finding addressed	Support (%) or source	Priority
9. District joint briefings; liaison officers	F3, F4	Friction met often or always by 56.9%	Interviews	Immediate
10. Joint civil-military SOP	F2, F4	"Three police stations, three systems" (FGD)	Interviews	Short term
11. Orientation attachments and annual joint exercises	F1, F5	Coordination named least confident by 36.7%	76.1; 75.0	Medium term

Note. Support = officers who agree (N = 360). Immediate = 6 months; short term = 18 months; medium term = 3 years.

Table 5.3

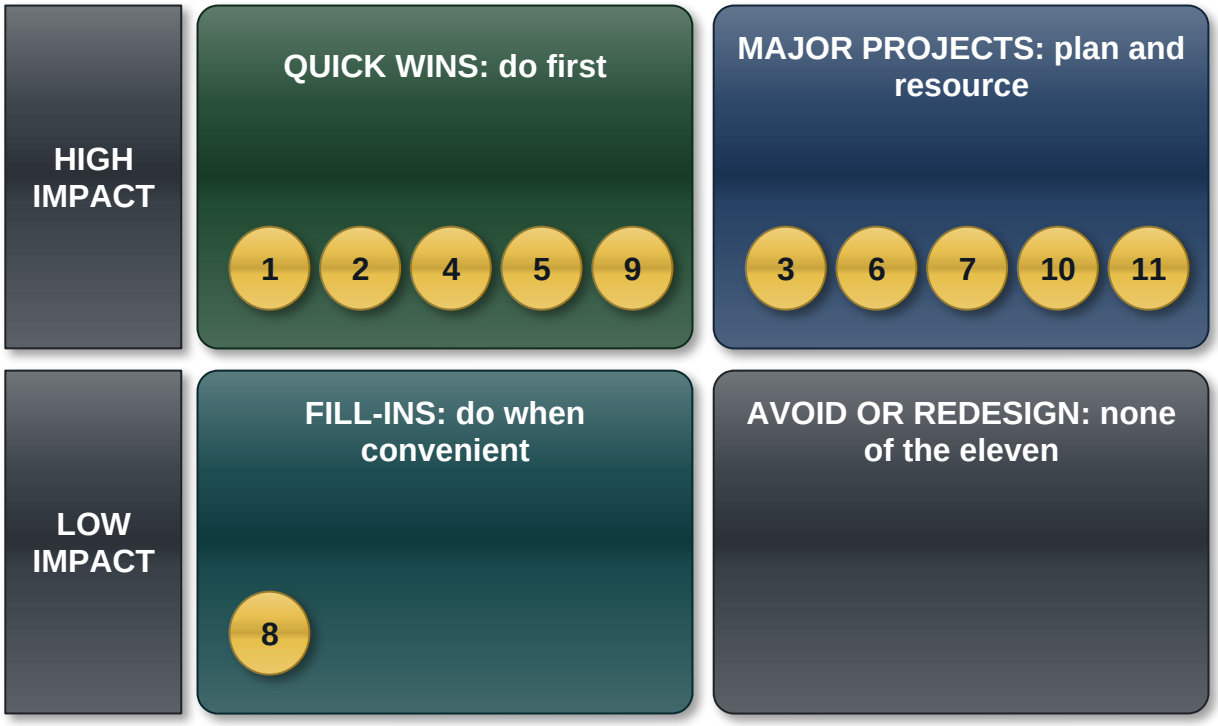
Factor and Measure Alignment Matrix

Measure	Level	F1	F2	F3	F4	F5	F6
1 Pocket aide-memoire	Individual		●		●		
2 Unit discussions, case reviews	Individual					●	●
3 Test before powers	Individual						●
4 Formation legal channel	Institutional				●		
5 Pre-deployment capsule	Institutional			●			
6 Revised MOOTW	Institutional		●				
7 Examined module	Institutional	●				●	
8 Biennial survey	Institutional						●
9 District joint briefings	Inter-agency			●	●		
10 Joint civil-military SOP	Inter-agency		●		●		
11 Attachments and exercises	Inter-agency	●				●	
Measures acting		**2**	**3**	**2**	**4**	**3**	**3**

Note. ● = the measure acts on the factor.

Figure 5.3

Impact and Effort Matrix of the Proposed Measures



Note. Researcher's assessment; numbers are measures in Table 5.2.

Individual Level

At the individual level officers take responsibility for personal legal competence: CrPC sections, arrest and seizure formats, custody time limits and the chain of requisition. Units should hold weekly legal discussions and review every case after deployment, and a test in magisterial procedure should precede any future delegation.

Institutional Level

At the institutional level the Army must build knowledge through doctrine, training and support. The module should follow Figure 5.2: state structure at BMA, procedure at SI&T and the arms and services schools, documentation and magistracy in captain-level courses, and planning at DSCSC. The Director of Military Training judged that a pilot at DSCSC could fit the calendar (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

Inter-Agency Level

At the inter-agency level the Army and civil agencies should learn to work together before a crisis, with joint briefings reaching company commanders. The DC

and SP of Sylhet both recommended liaison arrangements, common SOPs and table-top exercises (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026; R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026), and lieutenant colonels most strongly support attachments and joint exercises (84.6%).

Expected Benefit and Targets

Suppose the measures raised every officer to at least the moderate level in each domain. The share meeting each problem often or always would then move towards that of officers with moderate or better knowledge (Figure 5.4): documentation errors from 60.8% to about 41%, over-reliance from 57.5% to about 34%, friction from 56.9% to 35% to 37%, and hesitation from 66.4% to 47% to 51%. These figures are indicative, since the survey shows association, not cause. Figure 5.5 shows how the measures should produce the targets in Table 5.4, which turn the baseline into targets for the 2028 and 2030 surveys.

Figure 5.4

Estimated Share of Officers Meeting Each Problem Often or Always if Knowledge Were at Least Moderate

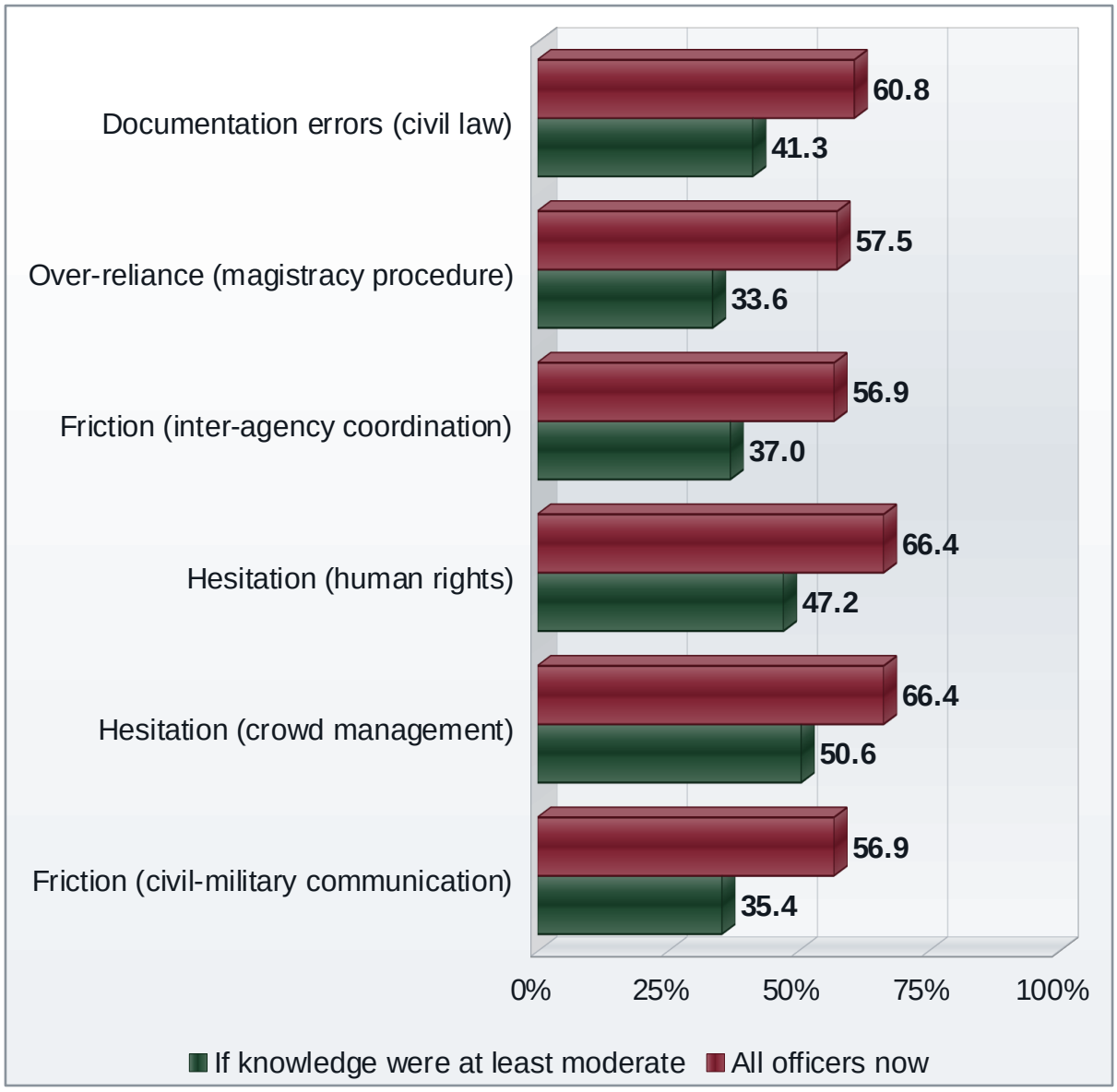


Figure 5.5

Theory of Change for Closing the Knowledge Gap

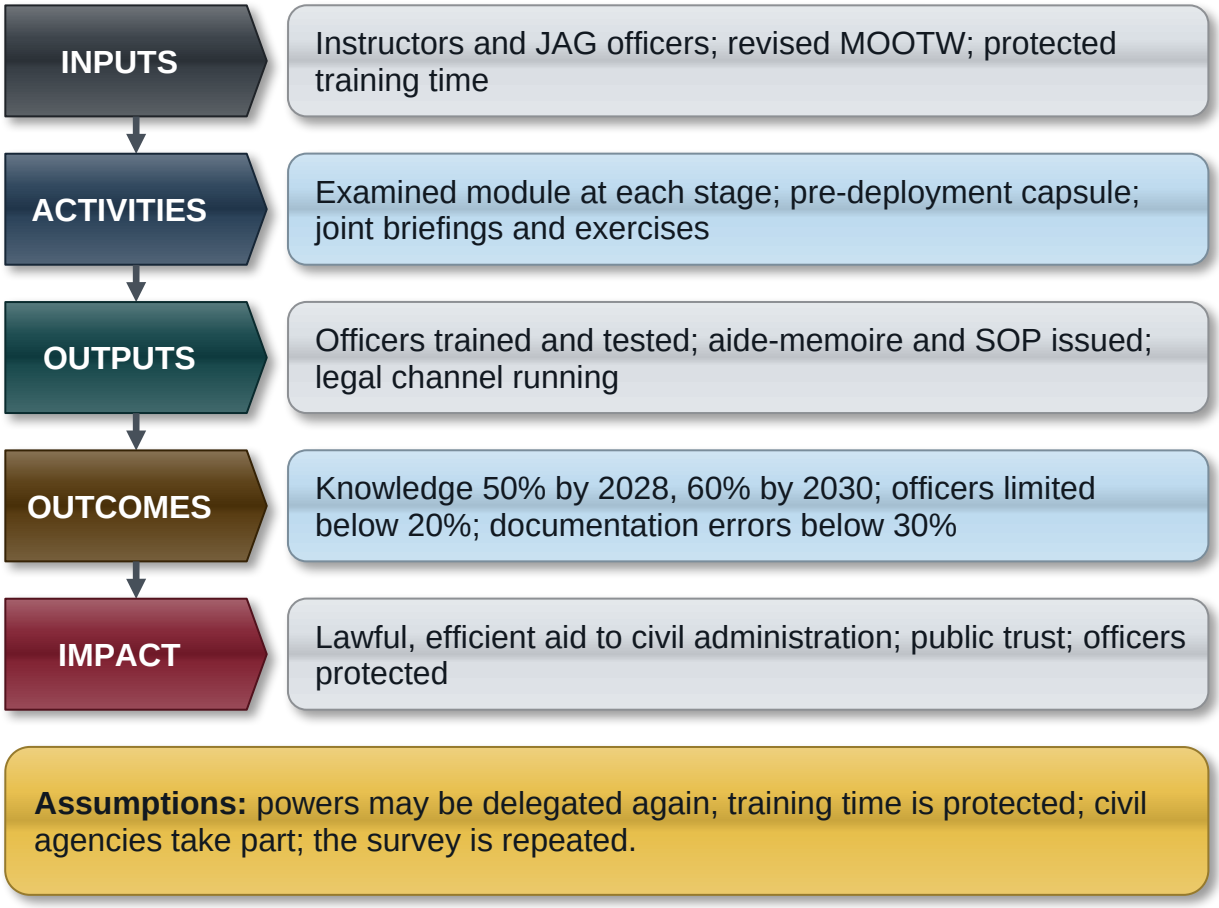


Table 5.4

Baseline and Proposed Targets for Measuring Progress

Indicator	Baseline (2026)	Target (2028 survey)	Target (2030 survey)
Knowledge, percentage of the scale maximum	39.3	50	60
Officers with limited knowledge (%)	65.6	Below 40	Below 20
Domains at or above the working standard	0 of 6	3 of 6	6 of 6
Officers who received institutional training (%)	30.3	60	100 of those liable for duty

Indicator	Baseline (2026)	Target (2028 survey)	Target (2030 survey)
Documentation errors often or always (%)	60.8	Below 45	Below 30
Hesitation often or always (%)	66.4	Below 50	Below 35
Officers certified before receiving magistracy powers (%)	0	100	100

Note. Researcher's own construct; 2028 targets follow Figure 5.4.

Conclusion

This study asked whether the civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers is adequate for aid to civil administration duties. The answer is no. Against a standard drawn from law, practice and comparable institutions, knowledge stands at 39.3% of the maximum and every domain falls short. The gap does not close with rank, service or deployments, it is linked to more hesitation, documentation errors, over-reliance and friction, and the civil officials who worked alongside the troops saw the same faults.

The cause lies in the institution: six factors sustain the gap in a cycle that no officer can break alone, so the remedy also lies in the institution. Magistrates and police officers train for months before they act. Since September 2024 Army officers have carried a magistrate's powers; they now need a magistrate's preparation, delivered through a career-long pathway and confirmed by a test before authority. Every measure fits within existing institutions; what is required is a decision to act.

Recommendations

Based on the findings, the following recommendations are made; Table 5.5 shows their timeline.

Individual Level

a. The Military Training Directorate, with the Judge Advocate General's (JAG) department, may issue a pocket aide-memoire to every officer liable for such duty by March 2027.

b. Commanding officers may include a monthly legal discussion and a post-deployment case review in unit training with immediate effect.

c. Army Headquarters (AHQ), with the Ministry of Public Administration and the JAG department, may make a test in magisterial procedure a precondition for magistracy powers before any future delegation.

Institutional Level

d. The JAG department may establish a round-the-clock legal advisory channel at formation level by June 2027.

e. ARTDOC may introduce a mandatory pre-deployment legal capsule, with an online phase, for any future delegation by June 2027.

f. ARTDOC may revise the MOOTW series with a dedicated aid to civil administration volume and approved study material by December 2027.

g. The Military Training Directorate may task ARTDOC to design a compulsory, examined module along Figure 5.2, piloted at SI&T and DSCSC by December 2027 and introduced at BMA and in all career courses by December 2028.

h. DSCSC may repeat the survey of this study every two years from 2028 and report progress against Table 5.4.

Inter-Agency Level

i. Formation headquarters, with district administrations and police, may hold joint briefings down to company commanders and appoint liaison officers before any future delegation.

j. AHQ, the Ministry of Public Administration and Bangladesh Police may issue a joint civil-military SOP for aid to civil administration by September 2027 and review it every year.

k. BMA and ARTDOC, with the Ministry of Public Administration, may introduce orientation attachments with district administrations and police stations, and AHQ, with the Bangladesh Public Administration Training Centre (BPATC), may hold annual joint exercises, both from January 2028.

Table 5.5

Implementation Roadmap of the Recommendations

Rec	Action	Q4 26	Q1 27	Q2 27	Q3 27	Q4 27	Q1 28	Q2 28	Q3 28	Q4 28
a	Pocket aide-memoire		Due							
b	Monthly legal discussion, case review									
c	Test before magistracy powers			Due						
d	Formation legal advisory channel			Due						
e	Pre-deployment legal capsule			Due						
f	Revised MOOTW volume					Due				
g	Examined module: design, pilot, all courses					Due				Due
h	Repeat survey every two years								Due	
i	District briefings, liaison officers									
j	Joint civil-military SOP				Due					
k	Attachments and joint exercises									

Note. Navy = individual; teal = institutional; green = inter-agency. Due = date in the recommendation.

Scope for Further Research

a. A tested, scenario-based assessment could replace self-assessment and measure the gap more exactly.
b. The same question could be asked of junior commissioned officers and non-commissioned officers, who do much of the work on the ground.
c. The first officers trained under the proposed module could be measured against the baseline of this study.
d. A comparison with the Navy and the Air Force, whose officers received the same powers, would show whether the pattern holds across the armed forces.

_____

SABRIN TABASSUM
Major
Course Participant
Course Number 02

Mirpur Cantonment
30 September 2026

Annexures:

A. Survey Instrument.
B. Calculations and Data Checks.
C. Legal Basis.
D. Summary of Interviews.
E. Summary of Focus Group Discussions.

Distribution:
Action:
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Annexure A
Survey Instrument

The survey was administered through Google Forms from 17 to 31 July 2026 to officers up to the rank of lieutenant colonel with experience of aid to civil administration. The form used the Army's term, aid to civil power (ACP). The questions are listed below as worded in the form, grouped by topic, with the response options in scale order. Items on which officers could select more than one option are marked. Service numbers and names were recorded only to detect duplicate submissions and were not analysed.

Profile

1. Rank [Lt; Capt; Maj; Lt Col].
2. Length of service [0 to 8 years; 8 to 15 years; 15 to 20 years; above 20 years].
3. Number of times employed in ACP duties [1 to 3 times; 3 to 5 times; more than 5 times].
4. Have you ever worked with any representative of civil administration jointly? [Yes; No; Maybe].
5. Types of ACP duties performed [open answer].

Knowledge

Stem: "Please rate your current level of knowledge in each area" [very limited; limited; moderate; adequate; high; very high].

6. Specific legal powers and limitations delegated to you as a Special Executive Magistrate.
7. Correct legal procedures for arrest, property seizure and documentation.
8. Organisation, role, structure and functions of the district and upazila civil administration (DC/UNO).
9. Legal preconditions and escalation sequence for dispersing an unlawful assembly (Section 141 of the Penal Code, 1860).
10. Legal and constitutional safeguards governing arrest, detention and custody.
11. Accepted principles on the use of force (necessity and proportionality).

12. Special procedural requirements for handling women, juveniles and vulnerable persons.
13. Scope and limitations of Special Executive Magistracy powers delegated to Army officers.
14. Graduated escalation and de-escalation measures with police and magistrates.

Perception of the Gap

15. Did you ever feel hesitant in taking decisions due to inadequate knowledge while deployed in ACP duties? [Yes; No; Maybe].
16. Does a significant knowledge gap exist among officers about civil administration and legal procedures? [highly significant; moderate; no, knowledge is adequate; unsure].
17. On which topic do officers feel least confident? (more than one) [applying SEM powers within legal limits; documentation for arrests, searches and evidence handover; coordination with DC, UNO and police; legal thresholds for crowd dispersal and use of force].
18. Are officers given adequate time to prepare legally and administratively before ACP tasks? [yes; sometimes; no, deployments are too sudden].
19. What is the most significant operational challenge caused by the gap? (more than one) [hesitation or delay; procedural errors in documentation; friction with police and civil administration; risk of legal overreach or rights violations].

Operational Effects

Stem: "Please indicate how frequently you have observed the following" [never; rarely; sometimes; often; always].

20. Hesitation, dilemma or delay in decision making due to uncertainty over legal boundaries.
21. Procedural errors in documentation, such as faulty arrest memos or seizure lists.
22. Jurisdictional friction or miscommunication with the civil administration over primary authority.
23. Over-reliance on civilian magistrates or police because officers lacked confidence in legal procedures.

Causes, Training and Importance

24. Causes of the gap [strongly disagree; disagree; neutral; agree; strongly agree]: no civil law and administration module in career courses; no mandatory pre-deployment training capsule; no field reference material (SOPs or handbooks); differing views of senior leadership; no precise or customised study material.
25. Training: institutional training received [yes; no; maybe]; adequacy of foundational career courses [not at all to very well]; emphasis of the training culture on civil administration [not at all to a large extent].
26. Importance of each of the six knowledge domains [not important; slightly important; moderately important; important; very important].

Measures

27. Should the Army take steps to bridge the gap? [yes; no; maybe].
28. Support for six measures [strongly disagree to strongly agree]: a compulsory civil law and administration module at BMA, arms and services schools or SI&T; an orientation attachment with the civil administration; mandatory pre-deployment training before SEM powers; regular joint exercises with BPATC; unit-level training to build a culture of learning; a legal advisory hotline.
29. Importance of a formal civil administration framework [not important to very important].

Two defects in the form were handled as follows. The middle option of the measures scale was printed as "Neutran" and was coded as neutral. The item on the need for institutional training carried an unlabelled option, "Option 1", chosen by 42 officers, and was therefore not analysed.

Annexure B
Calculations and Data Checks

Responses were exported from Google Forms to Microsoft Excel. Of 362 records, two from the same officer were removed: an abandoned partial submission and an earlier complete submission replaced by the officer's final answer. Knowledge answers were coded from very limited (1) to very high (6), and frequency, agreement and importance answers from 1 to 5. Table B1 shows how each figure in the paper was calculated.

Table B1

Calculations with Worked Examples from the Survey

Figure	Calculation	Worked example
Percentage	Number giving an answer ÷ number answering × 100	229 of 360 officers rated SEM powers limited or very limited: 229 ÷ 360 × 100 = 63.6%
Mean score	Sum of coded answers ÷ number of answers	SEM powers: 799 ÷ 360 = 2.22, in the limited band
Percentage of maximum	Mean ÷ highest possible score × 100	All nine questions: 2.36 ÷ 6 × 100 = 39.3%
Domain score	Average of the domain's questions	Civil law: (2.28 + 2.33) ÷ 2 = 2.30, or 38.4% of the maximum
Gap	Working standard (%) minus existing knowledge (%)	Civil law: 55 - 38.4 = 16.6 percentage points
Officer's knowledge level	Average of the officer's nine answers, read against Table 1.5	Answers 3, 3, 3, 2, 3, 2, 2, 2, 3: 23 ÷ 9 = 2.56, limited
Difference between groups	Percentage in one group minus percentage in the other	Documentation errors: 72.9 - 37.9 = 35.0 points
Two-proportion z-test	$z = (p_1 - p_2) \div \sqrt{[p(1 - p)(1/n_1 + 1/n_2)]}$, where p is the pooled proportion	Documentation errors: (0.729 - 0.379) ÷ 0.054 = 6.47, $p < .001$

Figure	Calculation	Worked example
Sample size	$n_0 = z^2 \times p(1 - p) \div e^2$; $n = n_0 \div [1 + (n_0 - 1) \div N]$	$1.96^2 \times 0.5 \times 0.5 \div 0.05^2 = 384$; for N = 1,000: 384 ÷ 1.383 = 278
Margin of error	$e = z \times \sqrt{[p(1 - p) \div n]} \times \sqrt{[(N - n) \div (N - 1)]}$	For n = 360: 1.96 × 0.0264 × 0.800 = 0.041, that is 4.1%

Note. z = 1.96 for 95% confidence; p = 0.5, the most cautious assumption; e = 0.05; N = estimated population. In the z-test, n_1 = 236 (limited) and n_2 = 124 (moderate or better).

Four checks were applied. Every record has complete answers to the knowledge and effect questions; all 10,799 coded answers matched the original text; the sample of 360 exceeds the 278 required; and the main results were recalculated without the 80 officers who gave the same answer to all nine knowledge questions (Table B2).

Table B2

Main Results with and Without the 80 Uniform Responders

Result	All officers (n = 360)	Without uniform responders (n = 280)
Knowledge, percentage of maximum	39.3	38.9
Officers with limited knowledge (%)	65.6	70.4
Difference in hesitation (points)	32.3	20.4
Difference in documentation errors (points)	35.0	26.0
Difference in over-reliance (points)	33.6	25.0
Difference in friction (points)	36.4	26.7

Note. Differences compare officers with limited knowledge and those with moderate or better knowledge. Every difference remains above the 10-point threshold of the decision rule.

Annexure C
Legal Basis

This annexure gives the official heading and effect of the provisions summarised in Table 2.3. Headings are taken from the Laws of Bangladesh portal (bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd), accessed on 26 September 2026. The 17 conferred sections were confirmed from press reports of the notification (The Business Standard, 2024a; The Daily Star, 2024a, 2024c), since the gazette itself was not available.

Table C1

Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898: Sections Relevant to Army Officers in Aid to Civil Administration

Section	Official heading	Effect	Status
12(1)	Special Magistrate	Government may give any person all or any powers of an Executive Magistrate; basis of SEM appointment	Enabling
17(1)	Subordination of Executive, Judicial and Metropolitan Magistrates	Executive Magistrates under ss. 10 and 12(1) are subordinate to the District Magistrate, who allocates their work	Enabling
64	Offence committed in Magistrate's presence	Magistrate may arrest, or order the arrest of, an offender in the magistrate's presence	Conferred
65	Arrest by or in presence of Magistrate	Magistrate may arrest, or direct the arrest in the magistrate's presence of, a person for whom a warrant could be issued	Conferred

Section	Official heading	Effect	Status
83	Warrant forwarded for execution outside jurisdiction	Receiving Executive Magistrate endorses the warrant and has it executed	Conferred
84	Warrant directed to police-officer for execution outside jurisdiction	Police officer takes the warrant to an Executive Magistrate for endorsement	Conferred
86	Procedure by Magistrate before whom person arrested is brought	Magistrate checks identity and sends the person to the issuing court	Conferred
95(2)	Procedure as to letters and telegrams	Magistrate may require postal authorities to search for and hold an item needed for a case	Conferred
100	Search for persons wrongfully confined	Magistrate may issue a search warrant to find a person wrongfully confined	Conferred
105	Magistrate may direct search in his presence	Search of a place in the magistrate's presence	Conferred
107	Security for keeping the peace in other cases	Bond to keep the peace for up to one year from a person likely to breach it	Conferred
109	Security for good behaviour from vagrants and suspected persons	Bond for good behaviour for up to one year	Conferred
110	Security for good behaviour from habitual offenders	Bond for good behaviour for up to three years	Conferred
126	Discharge of sureties	Release of a surety and demand for fresh security	Conferred

Section	Official heading	Effect	Status
127	Assembly to disperse on command of Magistrate or police officer	Command to an unlawful assembly, or assembly of five or more likely to disturb the peace, to disperse	Conferred
128	Use of civil force to disperse	Dispersal by civil force and arrest of those who refuse	Conferred
129	Use of military force	Executive Magistrate of highest rank present may have an assembly dispersed by military force	Not conferred
130	Duty of officer commanding troops required by Magistrate to disperse assembly	Officer must obey and use as little force and cause as little injury as possible	Conferred
131	Power of commissioned military officers to disperse assembly	Officer may act when no magistrate can be contacted, then follow the magistrate	Not conferred
132	Protection against prosecution for acts done under this Chapter	No prosecution without government sanction for acts done in good faith	Applies
133	Conditional order for removal of nuisance	Conditional order to remove a public nuisance or show cause	Conferred
142	Injunction pending inquiry	Immediate order to prevent imminent danger while a nuisance case is pending	Conferred

Note. Enabling = basis of the appointment; conferred = listed in the notification of 17 September 2024; not conferred = not listed; applies = applies to troops by law.

Table C2

Safeguards Binding Any Officer Who Arrests, Searches or Detains

Provision	Duty or limit
Constitution Art. 33	Person arrested to be told the grounds, allowed a lawyer and produced before a magistrate within 24 hours
Constitution Art. 35(5)	No torture or cruel, inhuman or degrading punishment or treatment
CrPC s. 46A (inserted by amendment)	Person making the arrest shows identity, prepares an arrest memo, informs the family within 24 hours and allows a lawyer
CrPC ss. 46D, 46E	Custodian cares for health; medical examination soon after arrest, by a female doctor for a woman where practicable
CrPC s. 50	No more restraint than necessary to prevent escape
CrPC s. 52	A woman is searched only by another woman, with strict regard to decency
CrPC s. 103	Search in presence of two respectable local witnesses; list of seized items signed by them
CrPC ss. 61, 167	No detention beyond 24 hours without a magistrate's order; police custody (remand) only on the order of a Judicial Magistrate
Evidence Act ss. 24 to 26	Confessions obtained by inducement or made in police custody are not admissible
Penal Code ss. 220, 330, 342	Offences of wrongful confinement by a person in authority, hurt to extort confession, and wrongful confinement
Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013	Torture and custodial death are criminal offences of the custodian

Provision	Duty or limit
Children Act, 2013 ss. 44, 45	No arrest below 9 years; no handcuff or rope; parents and probation officer informed
Appellate Division guidelines (2016)	Force only when strictly necessary; arrest memo; relative informed within 12 hours; female constable present when a woman is arrested

Note. Based on the instruments listed and *Bangladesh v. Bangladesh Legal Aid and Services Trust* (2016). The application of police-specific sections to an Army officer is by inference, since such an officer normally hands the arrested person to the police or a magistrate.

Table C3

History of the Magistracy Notifications, 2024 to 2026

Date	Notification
17 Sep 2024	Commissioned Army officers appointed Special Executive Magistrates nationwide for 60 days under CrPC ss. 12(1) and 17, for the 17 listed provisions
End Sep 2024	Same powers extended to commissioned officers of the Navy and Air Force
Nov 2024 to Sep 2025	Six extensions of 60 days each; from November 2024, limited to officers of captain rank or equivalent and above, including Army officers deputed to the Coast Guard and Border Guard Bangladesh
11 Nov 2025	Extended from 12 November 2025 to 28 February 2026, covering the national election
After 28 Feb 2026	No further nationwide extension found
22 Jun 2026	Army officers of captain rank and above appointed for 22 to 30 June 2026 in the Dhaka, Chattogram and Gazipur metropolitan areas and the Narayanganj, Gopalganj and Faridpur districts

Note. Based on The Business Standard (2024a), bdnews24.com (2024), The Daily Star (2025), Dhaka Tribune (2026) and The Financial Express (2026). The gazette notifications were not retrieved, and the exact date of the Navy and Air Force notification is unconfirmed.

Annexure D

Summary of Interviews

Six senior commanders and directors were interviewed on 14 July 2026, and the DC and the SP of Sylhet in July 2026. Semi-structured questions covered the knowledge gap, the September 2024 delegation, joint training and the stage of a career at which the knowledge should be taught. Respondents consented to attribution. Table D1 summarises the main points of each interview.

Table D1

Main Observations and Recommendations of the Interviewees

Respondent	Main observations	Main recommendations
Chief of General Staff, Lt Gen Md Mainur Rahman	Lack of orientation causes friction and minor delays; units may overstep limits or underuse the civil administration; powers without legal training led to overcaution and coordination gaps	Joint modules and exercises in the annual training cycle; state structure at BMA and field legal powers in basic and junior staff courses
Director of Infantry, Brig Gen M. M. H. Chowdhury	Companies arrive tactically ready but administratively blank; commanders unsure when dispersal is lawful; neighbouring companies read their powers differently; arrest papers not always as the law requires	Civil-military package in battalion collective training; teaching tied to the infantry career from BMA to NDC; documentation taught at company-commander level
Director of Military Training, Brig Gen Md Humayun Kabir	Training-to-task mismatch; officers unsure of limits on remand, summons and penalties; case diaries and evidence recording new to them; briefings alone are not enough	Certification before any future delegation; pilot at DSCSC in 2027; phased modules from BMA to NDC; a joint civil-military training cell

Respondent	Main observations	Main recommendations
Director of Military Operations, Brig Gen Dewan Mohammad Monzur Hossain	Gap seen in after-action reports; delayed authorisation, fragmented intelligence and stalled logistics; jurisdictional disputes after September 2024	Operational-legal certification first; division-level joint command post exercises; a pocket handbook for field commanders
Commander, 52 Infantry Brigade, Brig Gen Siafur Rahman	Commanders unsure whether a requirement goes to the DC or the SP; errors in detention records; small legal cell stretched thin; certification must come before delegation	Quarterly table-top and annual field exercises with civil agencies; reciprocal attachments; a brigade coordination cell with legal reference cards
Commander, Para Commando Brigade, Brig Gen MM Imrul Hasan	Specialised tasks carry the highest legal exposure: inadmissible evidence, challenged use of force and reputational damage	Legal module in commando courses; orientation with police special units; annual joint certification exercise; standing legal advice
DC and District Magistrate, Sylhet, Md. Abdullah Al Mamun	Preparedness rated 5 out of 10; superficial grasp of magisterial procedure and evidence; searches without warrants, detentions beyond limits and force without de-escalation; Sylhet detentions overturned and High Court scrutiny ordered	Handbook on aid to civil administration; pre-deployment orientation; district liaison cells; embedded legal advisers; common SOPs; joint table-top exercises; certification as a career requirement

Respondent	Main observations	Main recommendations
SP, Sylhet, Reazul Kabir	Rated 8 to 9 out of 10 for tactical tasks but 4 to 5 for civil functions; arrests without grounds documented; no chain of custody; female detainees without female custody staff; briefings not passed to company level	Pre-deployment legal orientation; round-the-clock legal advice; joint operations centres; annually updated joint SOPs; attachments to police stations

Note. In the text, interviews are cited as personal communications and are not listed in the references, in line with APA 7. NDC = National Defence College.

The eight interviews agree that the gap is real and visible on the ground, that the September 2024 powers were exercised sincerely but without enough legal preparation, and that joint training with the civil administration is both necessary and feasible within existing training cycles. They differ mainly in emphasis, from institutional reputation at Army Headquarters to legal exposure in specialised units and judicial accountability on the civil side.

Annexure E

Summary of Focus Group Discussions

Two FGDs were moderated by the researcher. The first was held at DSCSC on 20 July 2026 with four junior officers: Capt Abdullah Al Islam, Capt Kazi Farhan Sharif, Capt Md Akib Arshad Ouikko and Lt Tahmid Jaman. The second was held at an East Bengal battalion headquarters on 22 July 2026 with the battalion command group: Lt Col Md Shafiqul Islam (commanding officer), Maj M Hasan Al Mahmud (second-in-command), Maj Sk Md Muzahidul Islam and Maj Nur Muhamad Abu Jobayeer (company commanders) and Maj Md Mahfuzur Rahman (adjutant). Table E1 compares the main themes.

Table E1

Main Themes of the Two Focus Group Discussions

Theme	Junior officers (20 July 2026)	Battalion command group (22 July 2026)
How knowledge is gained	From NCOs, adjutants and a summary circulated on WhatsApp ("that PDF was our training")	From the commanding officer's own briefings and the adjutant's own formats, which leave the unit on posting
September 2024 powers	Uncertainty over authority when signing remand papers; police also unbriefed	Judicial power exercised after about two hours of lecture; outcome described as "luck, not design"
Coordination	Did not know the UNO on a first deployment; a young officer "either goes too soft or too hard"	Three police stations followed three systems; the first 72 hours of a deployment spent on orientation
Joint training	Short attachments to the DC office and police station; scenario-based, not ceremonial	Light, regular and reciprocal; coordination to be graded as well as tactics

Theme	Junior officers (20 July 2026)	Battalion command group (22 July 2026)
Where to teach	Basics at BMA; a graded serial at SI&T; unit refresher before standby; documentation as an assessed subject	Awareness at BMA; SI&T with magistrate role-players; DSCSC as the main fixing point; documentation taught with coordination

Note. NCO = non-commissioned officer. Quotations are from the FGD records.

Both groups confirmed that the gap is bridged by individual initiative rather than by the institution, and both raised documentation skills unprompted.